

Session 2 — «بارہ سال»

الصادق 's caliphate entire · 11–13 AH / 632–634 CE

Read this twice at home. It never goes to the lectern — that is what CUE.pdf is for. Its whole job is to put the evening into your head so completely that on the night you are telling it, not reading it. Everything here comes from SPINE.md ; nothing has been added.

All 64 cards are here, in SPINE.md 's order and with SPINE.md 's numbers. The 27 cards SPINE.md marks ★ are the recommended forty-five-minute cut, and each act's "Telling it" block names its own ★ cards. CUE.pdf prints the ★ cut and nothing else.

Where we are

Session 1 stopped on a morning. سقيفة was over, the ummah had a caliph, and the room was shown a map of Arabia with the ردة about to break across it. Then the lights came up. Tonight opens on that same map, unchanged, and starts moving it.

Tonight is **two years and three months**. That is the whole span. أبو بكر became caliph and died inside it, and inside it Arabia came apart and was put back together, the Qur'an was gathered into one set of صحف for the first time, and the first armies left the peninsula. The room will not believe how short it is — which is why the evening opens with a hands-up on exactly that.

The verdict after session 1 was that it felt like a speed-run. So tonight is one caliphate, told slowly, in scenes, with the map doing the joining.

How this briefing relates to the evening. SPINE.md now carries **64 cards**, and this briefing carries all 64, in the spine's order, numbered the same. That is deliberate over-build (DECISIONS.md #20): about seventy minutes of material for a forty-five-minute slot, so that you cut at the desk instead of hurrying on the night. **Twenty-seven of the 64 are marked ★ in SPINE.md as the recommended cut, and CUE.pdf prints those and nothing else.** Read the whole of this document twice; take the cue sheet to the lectern. Whatever does not fit rolls forward to session 3 — it is never compressed.

The one thing the evening is actually about. Every scene tonight is a man being told, by people who love him and are not fools, to bend — and not bending. Send the army later. Give us an older commander. Keep the troops here. Do not do a thing the Messenger of Allah ﷺ did not do. Take a salary you were lawfully voted. Each time he answers, and each answer is short. That is the thread. If you have to cut half the evening, keep the thread.

And one thing that is new since the first build of this evening: the room meets households, not names. ACT 3 is now the heart of the session, and it is built out of four of them. Zayd b. al-Khaṭṭāb رضى — عمر رضى's brother, who accepted Islam before him — carrying a banner and refusing to speak. أبو Hudhayfa رضى and his freedman Sālim رضى, master and freed slave, whose own father had fallen at Badr fighting the Muslims. Thābit b. Qays رضى, told years earlier how his life would end, putting on his burial clothes in the middle of a rout. And the house of مالك — Anas b. al-Naḍr رضى carried off أحد with more than eighty wounds and dead, and nine years later his nephew al-Barā' b. Mālik رضى carried off the wall of حديقة الموت with eighty-odd wounds and alive.

Four households walk onto one field in one morning. That is what the act is, and it is what the worksheet asks the room to write down. Do not tell them it is moving. Tell them the four stories in order and let them notice.

ACT 1 • The army he would not call back

11 AH • the first ten days

👏 [HANDS] Hands up — how long do you think أبو بكرؓ was caliph, in total?

(Two years and three months. Everything tonight happens inside that.)

1 • The order of battle at Uḥud

The evening does not open in ١١هـ. It opens nine years earlier, and not on a map — on a diagram of two wings of cavalry.

At أحد, Quraysh brought three thousand men and two hundred horses. Ibn Ishāq records exactly who led that cavalry. The right wing was under خالد بن الوليدؓ. The left wing was under 'Ikrima, the son of Abū Jahl. The whole army was commanded by Abū Sufyān b. Ḥarb.

Ask the room before you name them: *who commanded the Meccan army at Uḥud?* Let the guesses come. Then give all three names, and stop — do not draw the conclusion for them yet.

وَتَعَبَّأَتْ قُرَيْشٌ، وَهُمْ ثَلَاثَةُ آلَافٍ، وَمَعَهُمْ مِئَتَا فَرَسٍ قَدْ جَنَّبُوهَا، فَجَعَلُوا عَلَى مِيمَنَةِ
الْحَيْلِ خَالِدَ بْنَ الْوَلِيدِ، وَعَلَى مِيسَرَتِهَا عِكْرِمَةَ بْنَ أَبِي جَهْلٍ بْنِ هِشَامٍ

— البدايه والنهايه ج ٤ ص ١٨٠ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/1669>

English: "Quraysh drew up, three thousand of them, with two hundred horses they had led along; and they put Khālīd b. al-Walīd over the right wing of the cavalry, and 'Ikrima b. Abī Jahl b. Hishām over its left."

عبرت: A man's place in one line of battle is not his place in the next.

Why this is the first card of the evening. It is the only card that reaches backwards, and its whole job is to install one habit in the room before the war starts: watch what happens to the men who were on the other side. Hold the three names. Tonight collects on them four separate times — خالدؓ is handed the ridda command with a حديث about him on the caliph's lips, 'Ikrimaؓ is corrected and then sent from front to front, Waḥshīؓ throws the second of the two spears of his life, and Ṭulayḥaؓ walks back into Islam at the end of the caliphate.

Telling it: ninety seconds, and no commentary. The card is a picture and a list of three names. If you explain it here you spend it here.

2 • The appointment nobody liked

In his last weeks the Prophet ﷺ raised an army for the Syrian frontier and put أسامة بن زيد^{رضي} over it. أسامة^{رضي} was eighteen. Standing in the ranks under him were عمر بن الخطاب^{رضي} and the senior men of the مهاجرون and the أنصار. People said so out loud — an eighteen-year-old over these men. The Prophet ﷺ heard the talk, stood up, and answered it himself.

The audience will not expect the map to point where it points here. The arrow goes north-west, past تبوك, toward البلقاء and أُبْنَى — Byzantine ground. This is the first time in the series the map looks at an empire.

The statement is the Prophet's ﷺ own, and it does two things at once: defends أسامة^{رضي}, and tells the room how the Prophet ﷺ regarded him and his father.

إِنْ تَطْعُنُوا فِي إِمَارَتِهِ فَقَدْ كُنْتُمْ تَطْعُنُونَ فِي إِمَارَةِ أَبِيهِ مِنْ قَبْلُ، وَإِنَّمَا اللَّهُ إِنْ كَانَ خَلِيقًا لِلإِمَارَةِ، وَإِنْ كَانَ لِمَنْ أَحَبَّ النَّاسَ إِلَيَّ، وَإِنَّ هَذَا لِمِنْ أَحَبِّ النَّاسِ إِلَيَّ بَعْدَهُ

— البداية والنهاية ج ٥ ص ٣١١ <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/2495>

English: "If you find fault with his command, you found fault with his father's command before

him. And by Allah, he was fit for command, and he was among the dearest of people to me — and this

one is among the dearest of people to me after him."

عبرت: A man is fit for a task because of what he can do, not because of how long he has been alive.

3 • "I will not untie a knot"

Then the Prophet ﷺ died, and the situation inverted. Tribes around المدينه broke away. Others refused the رِكَاة. And the state's only field army was outside the walls, pointed at the Roman frontier and marching away from the capital.

The advice to recall it came from the best men he had. عمر^{رضي} was among them. The advice was correct by every ordinary measure. He refused it, and he refused hard.

والذي نفس أبي بكر بيده لو ظننت أن السباع تخطفني لأنفذت بعث أسامة كما
أمر به رسول الله ﷺ؛ ولو لم يبق في القرى غيري لأنفذته

— البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ١٠ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3156>

English: "By Him in whose hand is أبو بكر's soul — if I thought the wild beasts would snatch me

away, I would still send out أسامة's expedition as the Messenger of Allah ﷺ ordered it.

And if

there were no one left in the settlements but me, I would still send it."

عبرت: There is a kind of steadiness that is not stubbornness: it is refusing to treat an emergency as permission.

On the sources: the connected narrative here runs through سيف بن عمر; the wording at ج ٧ ص ١١ comes by a separate route. You do not need to say that on stage. You need to know it if a slip asks.

4 • The beard, and the man who would not be deposed

The column had reached الجُزْف, one march out. The أنصار in it sent عمر^{رضي} back with a second, much softer request — not "cancel the march", but "give us an older commander." عمر^{رضي} carried the message. أبو بكر^{رضي} had been sitting on the ground. He came up off it, took عمر^{رضي} by the beard, and answered in one sentence.

ثَكَلَتْكَ أُمُّكَ يَا ابْنَ الْخُطَّابِ! اسْتَغْمَلَهُ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ - صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ - وَتَأْمُرُنِي
أَنْ أَعْزِلَهُ؟!

— الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ١٩٥ — <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/886>

English: "May your mother lose you, son of الخطاب! The Messenger of Allah ﷺ appointed him — and you order me to depose him?"

عبرت: Authority that can be renegotiated the moment its author is gone was never authority.

5 • The caliph on foot

Then he walked the army out himself. Hold this picture for the room, because it is a picture and it needs no commentary: the caliph of the Muslims on foot in the dust; the eighteen-year-old commander in the saddle; عبد الرحمن بن عوف behind them leading the caliph's riding-beast, empty. أسامة could not bear it and offered to get down. He was refused.

And at the end أبو بكر asked one favour — and asked it of أسامة, not of عمر, because أسامة was the commander and عمر was in his army: *would you release عمر to me?*

فقال أسامة: يا خليفة رسول الله: إما أن تركب وإما أن أنزل، فقال: والله لست
بنازل ولست براكب

— البدايه والنهائيه ج ٧ ص ١١ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3157>

English: "أسامة said: 'O successor of the Messenger of Allah, either you ride or I dismount.' He said: 'By Allah, you shall not dismount, and I shall not ride.'"

عبرت: Rank is a place in an order, not a claim about who is the better man.

6 • Forty days, and what the tribes concluded

The column marched north through country that was ready to rise, and it did not fight its way through — it simply passed. And the men watching it pass drew the only conclusion available to them: nobody sends an army *away* unless he has more behind him. Forty days later — some say seventy — it came back whole and carrying spoil.

On the map, watch what happens: the arrow goes out, strikes, comes back, and the ring of hostile clans around المدينة **thins** instead of closing.

فجعل لا يمرُّ بقبيل يريدون الارتداد إلا قالوا: لولا أن لهؤلاء قوة ما خرج مثل هؤلاء
من عندهم

— البدايه والنهائيه ج ٧ ص ١١ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3157>

English: "He passed no tribe intending to break away but they said: 'Were it not that these people have strength, men like these would not have gone out from among them.'"

عبرت: What people believe about your strength does as much work as your strength does.

What the sources disagree about, and you should know: the blow the column struck is described differently in different books — a raid on **أُبنَى** in the **البلقاء**, or on **فُضاعة** clans that had broken away, or a clash with Roman forces. The two books that comment on the *effect* — **البدايه** ج ٧ ص ١١ and **الكامل** ج ٢ ص ١٩٦ — agree on it. **سير** ج ٢ ص ٤٩٧ names the target and says nothing about the effect, so do not enlist it for that. The forty days puts the return in **جمادى**, but **the month of the return is our arithmetic**, not a dated report on any page we have read. Do not state it as a date.

Telling it: Six minutes with card 1, five without. This is the easiest act to tell and the best place to settle your voice, so take it slowly and do not rush the first hands-up — let the guesses come, let them be wrong, then give the number. The two beats to pause on are the beard and the caliph walking; pause *after* the beard line, not before.

The ★ cut here is cards 2, 3 and 6. Cards 4 and 5 go first if you are long; card 6 absorbs their point. **Card 1 is not in the ★ cut — but cards 11, 48 and 54 all collect on it.** If you are keeping any of those three, keep card 1: it costs ninety seconds and it is what makes them land. If you drop card 1, drop the sentence in card 11 that refers back to it and say the fact in one clause instead.

What not to say: do not editorialise about **عمر** being wrong. He gave the advice any responsible man would give, and the story is far better if the room understands that the advice was *good* and was refused anyway. And **do not explain card 1.** Naming the three commanders of the Meccan army at **أحد** and then moving straight on is the whole of the device; the moment you tell the room what to expect from it, it stops working.

If a slip asks — "why put an eighteen-year-old over **عمر?"** The page is open: the Prophet **ﷺ** was asked that in his own lifetime and answered it himself. Card 2's quotation is the answer, and it is about fitness, not age. **If a slip asks whether **أبو بكر** and **عمر** quarrelled** — this is one government making a decision, not a dispute between Companions, and the same **عمر** is the man he later names as his successor. Go no further. If the slip is really reaching toward the **مشاجرات**, use the deferral line from **QA_BANK.md** §0: it is handled with **اصول** in session 3, and you do not adjudicate from the floor.

ACT 2 • Arabia comes apart

11 AH

7 • The night raid on Medina

The delegation that had offered the prayer and refused the رِكَاة went home. On the way out, they counted the men in the city.

Three days later the raiders came at night. Half of them stayed back at a valley called ذُو حُسى as a reserve. أَبُو بَكْر came out with whoever was in the mosque, on the watering-camels, and drove the raiders off — and then pursued them straight into the reserve, which rolled inflated skins down at the Muslims' camels. The camels bolted and carried their riders all the way home.

Flag this to the room as a surprise: the first engagement of the رِدَّة war was a reverse, and the book records it without embarrassment.

فَخَرَجَ عَلَيْهِمُ الرِّدَّةُ بِأَنْحَاءٍ قَدْ تَفَخُّوْهَا ... فَتَفَرَّتْ إِبِلُ الْمُسْلِمِينَ وَهُمْ عَلَيْهَا،
وَرَجَعَتْ بِهِمْ إِلَى الْمَدِينَةِ، وَلَمْ يُصْرَعْ مُسْلِمٌ.

— <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/893> · الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٠٢

English: "The reserve came out at them with skins they had inflated ... The Muslims' camels bolted with them on their backs and carried them back to Medina — and not one Muslim was thrown."

عبرت: The first engagement of the war was a setback, and the book records it without embarrassment.

Map caution: ذُو حُسى is a valley in the country of عَبَس and غُظْفَان. **No page we have gives its distance from المدينة, so do not name one.**

8 • The counter-attack before dawn

They thought the Muslims were finished. He spent that same night forming his men up — the three brothers of Muqarrin on the right, the left and the rear — and marched in the dark. At first light the two forces were standing on the same ground and the enemy had

not heard them come. The swords were among them before the sun's rim showed. By sunrise they were running.

He pursued, camped at ذُو الْقِصَّةِ, left a detachment there under al-Nu'mān b. Muqarrin^{رض}, and went home.

فَمَا طَلَعَ الْفَجْرُ إِلَّا وَهُمْ وَالْعَدُوُّ عَلَى صَعِيدٍ وَاحِدٍ ... فَمَا ذَرَّ قَرْنُ الشَّمْسِ حَتَّى
وَلَّوْهُمْ الْأَذْبَارَ ... وَكَانَ أَوَّلَ الْفَتْحِ.

— الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٠٣ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/894>

English: "Dawn did not break until they and the enemy were on one ground ... and the sun's rim had not risen before they turned their backs ... and that was the first victory."

عبرت: The recovery came out of the very night the reverse happened, spent preparing.

👏 [HANDS] Hands up — Medina is one town. How many armies would you send out at once?

٩ • Eleven banners at ذُو الْقِصَّةِ

This is the evening's biggest map moment. Do not spend it quickly.

He rode out a third time with his sword drawn, and 'Alī^{رض} walked at his camel's head. This time the Companions would not let him go on. He agreed — and then, on that ground, tied eleven banners, gave each commander his objective and his written orders, and went back to المدينة. The eleven separated, each with his own troops joining him, and rode off in eleven directions from one spot of desert.

On screen: one dot at ذُو الْقِصَّةِ, one day out from المدينة, and eleven arrows leaving it at once — north-east to نجد, east to اليمامة, north to الشام and to قُضَاعَة, south-east to البحرين, far east to عمان, south-east to مَهْرَة, south to اليمن and to تِهَامَة, south to حضرموت. They go up as outlines and fill in one by one across the rest of the evening. Count them out loud with the room.

فَفَصَلَتِ الْأُمَرَاءُ مِنْ ذِي الْقَصَصَةِ، وَلَحِقَ بِكُلِّ أَمِيرٍ جُنْدُهُ، وَعَهَدَ إِلَى كُلِّ أَمِيرٍ.

— ٢٠٤ ص ٢ الكامل · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/895>

English: "The commanders separated from Dhū al-Qaṣṣa, and each commander's troops joined him, and he gave each commander his commission."

عبرت: The whole war was set moving from one camp, in one sitting, by a man who had just been told to go home.

⚠ **Know this before you go on stage.** Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله announces eleven and prints ten; **prints all eleven**. If a listener has counted ten in another book, that is why. And **do not name the ninth commander** — three sources give three forms of the name.

10 • The letter that went ahead of the armies

Before the armies came, the letters came. One wording, copied out many times, carried by messengers who rode ahead of the columns, and read aloud in every assembly of the tribe.

The thing worth stopping on is what the letter contains: a single test that any man could apply from a distance, with no lawyer and no court. Call the adhān when you halt. If they answer it, stop. If they do not, ask them what they owe.

وقد أمرتُ رسولي أن يقرأ كتابه في كلِّ جَمْعٍ لَكُمْ، والداعية الأذان، فإذا إِذَّنَ المسلمون فأذنوا فكفوا عنهم، وإن لم يُؤذِّنوا فسلوهم ما عليهم.

— ٢٤ ص ٧ البدايه والنهايه · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3170>

English: "I have ordered my messenger to read his letter in every assembly of yours. The summons is the adhān: when the Muslims call it and they call it too, hold off from them; and if they do not call it, ask them what they owe."

عبرت: The test was something the other side could pass, and passing it stopped the war where they stood.

⚠ **The same letter contains a harsh clause. Do not quote it and do not deny it.** If a slip raises it: it is on that page, transmitted by سيف بن عمر; the operative test on the same page is the adhān; and the question of the clause is for the fuqahā', not for you. That is logged in [QA_BANK.md](#).

11 • The ḥadīth about the Sword of Allah, and who carries it

When خالد بن الوليد gave أبو بكر the command over the ridda campaign, he quoted something he had heard the Prophet ﷺ say about him. Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله puts the ḥadīth on the page at exactly that moment — not in a biography, not in a chapter of virtues, but in the sentence where the man is given an army.

The thing worth stopping on is not the praise. It is the isnād. The man who transmits it is Waḥshī b. Ḥarb — and twelve years earlier, at Uḥud, Waḥshī and خالد had stood on the same side of that field, and it was the other side. Card 1 has already put both of them there. This is where the room is allowed to notice it.

"نِعْمَ عَبْدُ اللَّهِ وَأَخُو الْعَشِيرَةِ، خَالِدُ بْنُ الْوَلِيدِ، سَيْفٌ مِنْ سُيُوفِ اللَّهِ سَلَّهُ اللَّهُ عَلَى
الْكُفَّارِ وَالْمُنَافِقِينَ"

— البدایہ والنہایہ ج ۷ ص ۲۴ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3170>

English: "What an excellent servant of Allah and brother of the clan — Khālīd b. al-Walīd; a sword among the swords of Allah, which Allah has drawn against the disbelievers and the hypocrites."

عبرت: The praise of one of them reaches us through the other.

⚠ **On the grading, know the whole of it and say very little of it.** The matn is graded ḥasan / ṣaḥīḥ by its other routes; **this particular chain, through Waḥshī b. Ḥarb, is weak.** From the platform say no more than *Imām Aḥmad رحمه الله records it*. Do not assert a grade, and do not volunteer the weakness either — you are naming a لقب the ummah already gave, not proving a report.

12 • بُرَاخَةُ — the man who walked off the field

Ṭulayḥa sat wrapped in a cloak, waiting for revelation, while 'Uyayna b. Ḥiṣn did the fighting with seven hundred men of Fazāra. Nearby, Banū 'Āmir sat armed and watched to see which way it would go. Three times 'Uyayna broke off the fighting, walked back to the cloak, and asked whether Jibrīl had come. Twice the answer was no. The third time it was yes — and then Ṭulayḥa told him what had been said.

Let the room hear the revelation before you comment on it. It is a mill, and a matter you will not forget. It says nothing. That is the point.

قَالَ لِي: إِنَّ لَكَ رَحًا كَرَحَاهُ، وَحَدِيثًا لَا تَنْسَاهُ. فَقَالَ عُيَيْنَةُ: قَدْ عَلِمَ اللَّهُ أَنَّهُ سَيَكُونُ
حَدِيثٌ لَا تَنْسَاهُ، أَنْصَرِفُوا يَا بَنِي فَزَارَةَ فَإِنَّهُ كَذَّابٌ.

— <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/896> · الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٠٥

English: "He said to me: you have a mill like his mill, and a matter you will not forget. 'Uyayna

said: Allah knows there will be a matter you will not forget. Withdraw, Banū Fazāra — the man is a liar."

عبرت: The claim collapsed the moment somebody asked it for something specific.

Ṭulayḥa's own exit is on the same page and it is worth having: he had a horse ready and a mount for his wife, got away with her, and called back over his shoulder — يَا مَعْشَرَ فَزَارَةَ، «مَنْ اسْتَطَاعَ أَنْ يَفْعَلَ هَكَذَا وَيَنْجُو بِامْرَأَتِهِ فَلْيَفْعَلْ — "whoever can do this and get away with his wife, let him do it." On the map a thin red line then runs from بُرَاخَةُ north-west, all the way to الشام.

13 • Ṭulayḥa at بُرَاخَةُ — the question, and the answer he got

Stay at بُرَاخَةُ for one more beat before the delegation rides to المدينة. Ṭulayḥa's men were breaking, and he asked one of them, plainly, what was defeating them.

This is the best hands-up of the first half, because the room will answer it with numbers and generalship and the page answers it with something else entirely. Ask: *why did the ridda armies lose?* Take two or three answers. Let them be reasonable. Then read what the

man actually said.

مَا يَهْزِمُكُمْ؟ فَقَالَ رَجُلٌ: أَنَا أَحَدُكُمْ، لَيْسَ مِنَّا رَجُلٌ إِلَّا وَهُوَ يُحِبُّ أَنْ يَمُوتَ صَاحِبُهُ
قَبْلَهُ، وَإِنَّا نَلْقَى قَوْمًا كُلُّهُمْ يُحِبُّ أَنْ يَمُوتَ قَبْلَ صَاحِبِهِ

— سير أعلام النبلاء، ج الخلفاء الراشدون ص ٤١ — <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1189>

English: "'What is defeating you?' A man said: I will tell you. There is not one of us but he would rather his companion died before him — and we are meeting a people every one of whom would rather die before his companion."

عبرت: The difference was not in the numbers, and the losing side could see it.

عبرت note: this is the one card in the first half that explains the whole year rather than narrating a piece of it, and it does so in the enemy's own mouth — which is why it is worth more than any figure. Do not add to it. The comparison is already complete on the page.

14 • The terms at Medina, and ^{رض}عمر's objection

The delegation of ^{رض}بكر came to المدينة asking for terms. ^{رض}أبو بكر gave them a choice of two and named them: a war of expulsion, or a humbling settlement. They said they knew what war meant — what was the settlement? He listed it. Weapons and horses surrendered. Compensation for what you took from us, and none for what we took from you. You testify that our dead are in the Garden and yours in the Fire. And you pay blood-money for our dead, and we pay none for yours.

And then ^{رض}عمر interrupted him — in public, in front of the men the terms applied to — and struck one clause out.

فَقَالَ عمر: أما قولك: تدون قتلانا، فَإِنَّ قتلانا قتلوا على أمر الله لا ديات لهم ...

وقال عمر في الثاني: نعم ما رأيت.

— صحيح البخاري ٧٢٢١ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3173> · البدايه والنهائيه ج ٧ ص ٢٧ —

English: "Umar said: as for your saying 'and you pay blood-money for our dead' — our dead were

killed upon the command of Allah; there is no blood-money for them ... And 'Umar said of the rest:

excellent is what you have judged."

عبرت: The terms were read out in front of the men they applied to, and one clause of them was struck out in public.

Two additions, both on the page and both useful. Ibn Mas'ūd[ؓ] defines the first option — **بُراخة** **at** **no captives were taken** (الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٠١) «وَأَمَّا الْحَرْبُ الْمُجَلِيَّةُ فَأَنْ يُخْرِجُوا مِنْ دِيَارِهِمْ» (الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٠٦) «فَأَمْنَهُمْ ... وَلَمْ يُؤْخَذْ مِنْهُمْ سَبْيٌ». Say the second one. The room will assume captives were taken; the page says they were not, and there is no captives marker on the map.

Telling it: About six minutes, and this act has the most moving parts — so hold the running order in your head rather than the detail: *raid* → *reverse* → *night march* → *victory* → *eleven banners* → *letters* → *the sword of Allah* → بُراخة → *the question* → *terms*. Ten beats now, and they go quickly. The second hands-up sits between the night march and the banners and does real work: let them guess two, or three, then put eleven arrows on the screen.

The ★ cut here is cards 7, 9, 11, 12 and 14. If you are running long, tell card 8's night march in two sentences, drop the Banū 'Āmir detail from card 12, and let card 13 go — it is the best card in the act and it is also the most cuttable, because nothing later depends on it. **Card 9 must not be shortened.**

What not to say: do not call the ردة a rebellion of hypocrites or characterise the tribes' motives beyond what the pages say, and do not let the word "apostasy" do more work than the letter does — the letter's own test is the adhān. On card 11, **do not grade the ḥadīth from the platform.** Say that Imām Aḥmad رحمه الله records it, name the man who transmits it, and move.

If a slip asks — "were these wars fought against Muslims?" Open the page rather than argue. The letter sets a low test: call the adhān; if they call it back, hold off. Those who called it were left alone. Beyond that, whether a given group was inside or outside Islam is a question for the fuqahā' — and the honest answer, which is also the disarming one, is that you are reading a book and telling the room what is in it. That is line 3 in `QA_BANK.md` §0, and it is true.

ACT 3 • اليمامة

11–12 AH • the hardest day of the war

15 • Two brothers by appointment

This card opens the act, and it is the frame the act has been missing. Do not skip it to get to the battle.

When the مهاجرون arrived in المدينة with nothing, the Prophet ﷺ paired each of them with a man of the أنصار and made the two of them brothers. That is the مؤاخاة, and the room has heard of it. What the room has not heard is what it looked like a decade later.

Zayd b. al-Khaṭṭāb^{رضي}, of Quraysh, was paired with Ma'n b. 'Adī^{رضي} of Banū al-'Ajlān, an ally of the أنصار. Years later both of them were on the field at اليمامة. Both of them were killed there, on the same day. And they were not the only such pair: Abū Ḥudhayfa^{رضي} and 'Abbād b. Bishr^{رضي} had been paired the same way, and they died there too.

Say to the room, once, what the act is going to do: *four households are about to walk onto one field, and you are going to meet each of them before it happens*. Then let the act deliver them.

وقد آخى رسول الله ﷺ بينه وبين معن بن عديّ الأنصاري وقد قُتلا جميعًا باليمامة.

— البدايه والنهائيه ج ٧ ص ٤٩ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3195>

English: "The Messenger of Allah ﷺ made him and Ma'n b. 'Adī al-Anṣārī brothers, and the two of them were killed together at al-Yamāma."

عبرت: The tie was made in a year when they owned nothing, and it was still holding on the day they died.

The second pair is on البدايه ج ٧ ص ٥٥ — وآخى رسول الله ﷺ بينه وبين عبّاد بن بشر وقد قُتلا شهيدين» — and سير ج ١ ص ٢٩٨ — «يوم اليمامة carries the first pairing independently.

A dating caution you should know and never say aloud: the مؤاخاة is placed at the arrival in المدينة, but **the approved sources give it no year**. اليمامة in ١٢هـ is sourced; the pairing's year is not. Say "years later", which is what the page supports, and never a number of years.

16 • The son of the elder of the Jāhiliyya

Abū Ḥudhayfa^{رضي} was the son of 'Utba b. Rabī'a — one of the great men of Quraysh before Islam. Al-Dhahabī رحمه الله, opening his notice on him, does not soften that by one word. In a single sentence he calls him a martyr, calls his father the elder of the Jāhiliyya, and calls him a man of Badr. Abū Ḥudhayfa^{رضي} had accepted Islam before the Companions were even meeting in the house of al-Arqam.

Ask the room, before you read it: *who here has a relative who did not agree with the biggest decision they ever made?* Leave the hands up for one beat and move on. Do not develop it, do not invite anyone to speak, and do not make it warm. It is a door you open two inches and then close.

السَّيِّدُ الْكَبِيرُ، الشَّهِيدُ، أَبُو حُذَيْفَةَ ابْنُ شَيْخِ الْجَاهِلِيَّةِ: عُتْبَةُ بْنُ رَبِيعَةَ ... الْقُرَشِيُّ،
الْعَبْشَمِيُّ، الْبَدْرِيُّ

— سير أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ١٦٤ — <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1590>

English: "The great chief, the martyr, Abū Ḥudhayfa — son of the elder of the Jāhiliyya, 'Utba b. Rabī'a — al-Qurashī, al-'Abshamī, the man of Badr."

عبرت: A man's descent is recorded honestly, and it is not what he is judged by.

عبرت **note:** the sentence to let land is that the books record the descent honestly and then do not judge him by it. That is a fact about the historical method, not a compliment, and it is worth more said flatly than said kindly.

17 • The face the Prophet ﷺ noticed at the well

After Badr the dead of Quraysh were put into the well. 'Utba b. Rabī'a was taken and dragged to it. The Prophet ﷺ looked at the face of his son and saw that it had gone pale — and asked him, directly, whether something had entered him about his father.

The answer is the reason this card is in the evening. It is not a denial of grief. He said he had never doubted his father nor where he fell; but he had known a judgement and a forbearance in the man, and had hoped it would bring him to Islam, and it had not — and that grieved him. The Prophet ﷺ prayed for him and spoke kindly to him.

Read it slowly. The room will be expecting a rebuke and there is none.

لما سحب عتبة بن ربيعة إلى القليب نظر رسول الله ﷺ في وجه أبي حذيفة ابنه، فإذا هو كئيب متغير. فقال: "لعلك قد دخلك من شأن أبيك شيء؟". قال: لا والله ما شككت في أبي ولا في مصرعه، ولكني كنت أعرف منه رأيا وحلما، فكنت أرجو أن يسلم، فلما رأيت ما أصابه وما مات عليه أحزني ذلك. فدعا له النبي ﷺ وقال له خيرا

— <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/449> ص ٣١٢ (السيرة النبوية) سير أعلام النبلاء —

English: "When 'Utba b. Rabī'a was dragged to the well, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ looked into the face of his son Abū Ḥudhayfa, and there he was, downcast and changed. He said: 'Perhaps something has entered you about the matter of your father?' He said: No, by Allah, I have not doubted my father nor where he fell. But I knew in him a judgement and a forbearance, and I used to hope he would accept Islam; and when I saw what befell him and what he died upon, that grieved me. So the Prophet ﷺ prayed for him and spoke kindly to him."

عبرت: He was not told that grief was a fault, and he did not pretend he had none.

Telling it: this is a quiet card and it should be quiet. Do not raise your voice anywhere in it.

What not to say: do not speculate about 'Utba's state, do not say anything about where he is, and do not turn the card into a lesson about loving one's parents. The page's own point is narrower and better: he was not told that grief was a fault, and he did not pretend he had none.

18 • From Iṣṭakhr to the banner of the مهاجرون

Now the second man of that household, and the map does something it does only once tonight: a faint line comes *into* Arabia rather than out of it.

Sālim^{رض} was a slave. His origin was إصطخر^{رض} in Persia. The woman of Abū Ḥudhayfa's^{رض} household freed him, and Abū Ḥudhayfa^{رض} took him as his own. Al-Dhahabī رحمه الله opens his notice with four descriptions in a row, and not one of them is about where he came

from.

Ask before you read it: *where do you think the man who led the مهاجرون in prayer came from?* Then read the four titles, and let إصطخر arrive at the end of the sentence, where the book puts it.

مِنَ السَّابِقِينَ الْأَوَّلِينَ، الْبَدْرِيِّينَ، الْمُقَرَّبِينَ، الْعَالَمِينَ ... أَصْلُهُ مِنْ إِصْطَخَرَ

— سير أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ١٦٧ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1593>

English: "Of the first forerunners, of the men of Badr, of those brought near, of the learned ...

his origin is from Iṣṭakhr."

عبرت: The books record where he came from in four words and what he became in four titles.

⚠ **Do not go further into the adoption than the page goes.** There is a well-known question of fiqh attached to this household. It is not in tonight's material, it is not on any card, and it is not a thing to open in front of a mixed hall from a lectern. If a slip reaches for it, say plainly that it is a question of fiqh, that it belongs to the fuqahā', and that you are reading a history book. That answer is true and it is enough.

19 • The imām at قُبَاء

The مهاجرون reached المدينة before the Prophet ﷺ did. They camped at al-'Uṣba, beside قُبَاء, and they had to pray. Somebody had to lead.

They put forward a freed slave, because he had more of the Qur'an than any of them. Among the men praying behind him was عمر بن الخطاب رضي الله عنه.

Say the last sentence last, and do not add anything to it.

أَنَّ الْمُهَاجِرِينَ نَزَلُوا بِالْعُصْبَةِ إِلَى جَنْبِ قُبَاءَ، فَأَمَّهُمْ سَالِمٌ مَوْلَى أَبِي حُذَيْفَةَ، لِأَنَّهُ كَانَ
[ص ١٦٩] أَكْثَرَهُمْ قُرْآنًا، فِيهِمْ عُمَرُ، وَأَبُو سَلَمَةَ بْنُ عَبْدِ الْأَسَدِ

— ١٦٨ ص ١٦٩ — سير أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ١٦٨ — <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1594> و <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1595>

English: "The Muhājirūn camped at al-‘Uṣba beside Qubā’, and Sālīm, the freedman of Abū

Ḥudhayfa, led them in prayer, because he had the most Qur’ān of them — among them ‘Umar and Abū

Salama b. ‘Abd al-Asad."

عبرت: The first thing the Muhājirūn did on arriving was to put the best reciter in front, whoever he was.

Telling it: thirty seconds, and it is one of the two or three lines from tonight that people repeat afterwards. The whole force of it is in the order of the words — the reason first, the name of the man standing behind him second. Reverse them and it dies. **What not to say:** do not make a speech about equality. The page makes it, in six words, and any sentence you add subtracts.

20 • The tent and the prisoner — عَقْرَبَاءَ

Musaylima had about forty thousand fighting men. He camped at عَقْرَبَاءَ with the farmland and the families behind his back — which meant no man in his line could retreat without running through his own household. Say that plainly and let the room work out what it does to a battle.

The night before, خالد's vanguard picked up a raiding party coming home. He executed them and kept one man alive, because someone in the party told him to: *if you mean anything at all for the people of اليمامة tomorrow, keep this one*. The man was Mujjā'a b. Murāra, and he was put in irons in the tent with خالد's wife, with an instruction to treat him well.

أيها الرجل إن كنت تريد بأهل اليمامة غدًا خيرًا أو شرًا فاستبق هذا الرجل ...
فاستبقاه خالد مقيّدًا، وجعله في الخيمة مع امرأته، وقال: استوصي به خيرًا.

— <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3179> · البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٣٣

English: "Man — if you intend anything tomorrow for the people of Yamāma, good or ill, keep this man alive ... So Khālīd kept him, in irons, and put him in the tent with his wife, and said: treat him well."

عبرت: He kept one prisoner alive on a stranger's advice, and that decision settled the end of the battle before it started.

21 • The line breaks

This is the beat the act has been walking toward, and it is a reverse. Tell it as one.

One of their leaders told them that if they lost, their women would be taken. The armies collided, and the Muslim line broke. The bedouin contingents ran. Banū Ḥanīfa came through and into خالد's^{بنو} own tent, and were going to kill his wife — and the prisoner in irons in that tent, the man kept alive on a stranger's advice the night before, stood up and gave her his protection.

And later in the same day Muslims came into that same tent meaning to kill him, and she gave him hers.

فكانت جولة وانهمزت الأعراب حتى دخلت بنو حنيفة خيمة خالد بن الوليد وهموا
بقتل أم تميم، حتى أجارها جماعة وقال: نعمت الحرّة هذه.

— <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3179> · البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٣٣

English: "There was a rout: the bedouin broke, until Banū Ḥanīfa entered Khālīd b. al-Walīd's own tent and were minded to kill Umm Tamīm — until Mujjā'a gave her his protection and said: This is a fine free woman."

عبرت: Each of them saved the other's life on the same day, and the book keeps both halves.

سير) سير أعلام النبلاء — «وَاللَّهِ لَا يُقْتَلُ، وَأَجَارَتْهُ: فَقَالَتْ أُمُّ تَمِيمٍ»: سير
https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1195. ص ٤٧ (الحلفاء الراشدين

Tell both halves or neither. Half of this card is a curiosity; the whole of it is the reason the book kept it.

22 • The banner, and the vow of silence

The line is going backwards, and the act now gives you four men rallying it, one after another. This is the first of them, and he is the one the room already half knows: Zayd b. al-Khaṭṭāb^{رض} — عمر^{رض}'s brother, who had accepted Islam before him.

He was carrying a banner. He told the men to bite down on their back teeth, strike into the enemy and go forward. Then he said that he would not speak again — not one more word — until either Allah routed them, or he met Allah and put his case to Him himself.

He went forward with the banner and did not stop going forward. He was killed. The banner fell, and Sālim^{رض}, the freedman of Abū Ḥudhayfa^{رض}, picked it up. That is the join between this card and the next household, and it happens on the ground, not in your commentary.

وقال زيد بن الخطاب: أيها الناس عَضُّوا على أضراسكم، واضربوا في عدوكم وامضوا
قدماً، وقال: والله لا أتكلّم حتى يهزمهم الله أو ألقى الله فأكلّمه بحجّتي، فقتل
شهيداً □.

— البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٣٤ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3180>

English: "Zayd b. al-Khaṭṭāb said: People — bite down on your back teeth, strike into your enemy

and go forward. And he said: By Allah, I will not speak until Allah routs them, or I meet Allah and

speak to Him with my case. And he was killed a martyr."

عبرت: He put a limit on his own speech and none at all on his own advance.

⚠ **Three approved books give three different banner arrangements.** Say *he carried a banner* and **never draw the diagram**. الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢١٧ has a longer wording of the same vow — **do not merge the two wordings**; use the one above, under the caption above.

23 • «Are you not content to live praised?»

Play this immediately before the shroud. Without it the shroud is a gesture; with it, it is a fulfilment.

Thābit b. Qays^{رض} was the orator of the أنصار and he had a very loud voice. When the verse came down forbidding the believers to raise their voices above the Prophet's ﷺ, he concluded that he was of the people of the Fire. He shut himself in his house and stopped coming.

The Prophet ﷺ noticed he was missing and sent to find out why. When he heard the reason, he said Thābit^{رض} was of the people of the Garden. And in another report he told him what would happen to him — three things, in order.

فَقَالَ: (يَا ثَابِتُ! أَمَا تَرْضَى أَنْ تَعِيشَ حَمِيداً، وَتُقْتَلَ شَهِيداً، وَتَدْخُلَ الْجَنَّةَ)

— سير أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ٣١٠ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1736>

English: "He said: Thābit — are you not content to live praised, to be killed a martyr, and to enter the Garden?"

عبرت: He was told the end of his own life years before it happened, and then he lived as though he believed it.

The verse-and-house incident is in صحيح مسلم ١١٩ and صحيح البخاري ٣٦١٣ ج ٧ البدايه ج ٧ carries this and the earlier لقمان ١٨ incident in sequence.

Telling it: read the three promises and then stop talking for two seconds before you move to the next card. The room needs the gap to hear the third one — *and enter the Garden* — before the perfume comes out. That silence is doing the work of a paragraph.

24 • Thābit b. Qays^{رض} puts on his shroud

Hold the map still for this one. Nothing moves; you are standing on one patch of ground at عَقْرَبَاء while the Muslim line goes backwards.

Anas^{رضي} came to Thābit b. Qays^{رضي} and found him rubbing himself with burial perfume. He had put on two white garments — the ones he was buried in. Anas^{رضي} said: do you not see what is happening? He said: in a moment, nephew. Then he walked forward past the men who were falling back, told them to get out of his way, and said the thing that everyone in that generation would have understood instantly. Then he took the أنصار's banner, dug his feet into the ground to the middle of his shins, and did not move from there until he was killed.

هَكَذَا عَنْ وُجُوهِنَا تَقَارِعُ الْقَوْمَ، بِئْسَ مَا عَوَّدْتُمْ أَقْرَانَكُمْ، مَا هَكَذَا كُنَّا نُقَاتِلُ مَعَ
رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ.

— صحيح البخاري ٢٨٤٥ — <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1737> · سير أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ٣١١

English: "Get out of our faces so we can strike the enemy. Wretched is what you have accustomed

your opponents to! This is not how we used to fight alongside the Messenger of Allah

ﷺ."

عبرت: He did not tell them what to do; he told them what they had already been.

In the same minutes, on the same field. البدايه ج ٧ ص ٣٤ puts four voices inside one paragraph. Three of them now have cards of their own and are told in sequence around this one — Zayd b. al-Khaṭṭāb's^{رضي} vow is card 22, Sālim's^{رضي} answer is card 25, Abū Ḥudhayfa's^{رضي} call is card 26. **Do not say them here as well; you would spend them twice.**

The fourth has no card, and it belongs here, because it is the whole army rather than one man — they were calling to each other «يا أصحاب سورة البقرة، بطل السحر اليوم» (البدايه ج ٧ ص ٣٣).

Sālim^{رضي} is the man the Prophet ﷺ went out at night to listen to — سير ج ١ ص ١٦٨. Keep that one line for card 25, where it does more work than any adjective you could add.

25 · "A wretched bearer of the Qur'ān I should be"

The banner of the مهاجرون is in Sālim's^{رضي} hands now, and the man who carried it before him was killed carrying it. The line has already broken once. The men around him asked him plainly whether he was afraid it would be broken from his side.

His answer was one sentence, and two separate books record it in the same words.

وقال المهاجرون لسالم مولى أبي حذيفة: أتخشى أن نؤتى من قبلك؟ فقال: بئس حامل القرآن أنا إذا

— البدايه والنهائيه ج ٧ ص ٣٤ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3180>

English: "The Muhājirūn said to Sālim, the freedman of Abū Ḥudhayfa: Do you fear we shall be broken from your side? He said: A wretched bearer of the Qur'ān I should be, then."

عبرت: He answered a question about his courage by naming what he carried.

Telling it: twenty seconds. Do not set it up and do not explain it afterwards. The question is about his courage and the answer is about what he is carrying, and the room hears the substitution without being told it is there.

26 • "Adorn the Qur'ān with deeds"

Same field, same hour. Abū Ḥudhayfa^{رضي} was calling out to the men around him — and he did not call them by tribe and he did not call them by clan. He called them the people of the Qur'an, and told them what to do about it.

Then he charged, drove the enemy back, and was struck down.

وقال أبو حذيفة: يا أهل القرآن زينوا القرآن بالفعال، وحمل فيهم حتى أبعدهم وأصيب □

— البدايه والنهائيه ج ٧ ص ٣٤ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3180>

English: "Abū Ḥudhayfa said: People of the Qur'ān — adorn the Qur'ān with deeds. And he charged into them until he drove them back, and he was struck down^{رضي}."

عبرت: The last thing he asked of anyone was that what they recited and what they did should match.

Put cards 25 and 26 together in your head as one beat: the master and the freedman, thirty seconds apart on the same ground, each answering the same question in a different sentence. The room does not need that pointed out. It needs the two sentences delivered close enough together to be heard as a pair.

27 • The armour in the cooking pot

Now the act moves off the field and back to المدينة — which is where it has to end.

Thābit b. Qays^{رضي} was killed at اليمامة and his coat of mail, a valuable one, was stolen off his body by a Muslim, who hid it. A man of the army then saw Thābit^{رضي} in a dream. In the dream he told him where the mail was: at the far end of the camp, under an upturned cooking pot with a pack-saddle set on top of it.

Then he gave him three things to say to the caliph in المدينة — a debt he owed, property he had, and a slave of his who was to be freed. And twice he told the man not to dismiss it as a dream and let it go to waste.

The man went to خالد^{رضي}. The mail was exactly where he had said. And in المدينة أبو بكر^{رضي} carried out the will of a man who was already dead.

فأنفذ أبو بكر وصيته بعد موته، فلا نعلم أحداً جازت وصيته بعد موته إلا ثابت
بن قيس بن شماس.

— البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٤٨ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3194>

English: "And Abū Bakr executed his will after his death. And we know of no one else whose will was carried through after his death except Thābit b. Qays b. Shammās."

عبرت: The two things he sent back were the same two things: return what was taken, and pay what is owed.

⚠ **Report the chain the way the books do, and build nothing on it.** Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله says the account has other corroborating reports; his editor notes that the daughter in the chain is unknown; and al-Haythamī's رحمه الله line is the one to give aloud — «هو في الصحيح» — the rest of the report is in the Ṣaḥīḥ, the episode of the mail is not. **Do not derive any ruling about dreams from it**, and do not let the card become a story about dreams at all. It is a story about two debts being paid.

28 • «I find the scent of Paradise»

The evening's strongest pairing starts here, and it does not pay off for another four cards. Plant it properly.

Anas b. al-Naḍr^{رضي} had missed Badr, and it weighed on him. He said that if Allah ever gave him a battle, Allah would see what he did.

At أحد^{رضي} the Muslim line broke. He walked forward with his sword and met Sa'd b. Mu'adh^{رضي} on the way, and told him he could smell Paradise, on this side of the mountain. Then he went in, and fought until he was killed. Sa'd^{رضي} said afterwards that he himself could not do what that man had done.

Ask the room first: *has anyone here ever missed something and spent years wishing they had been there?* Then tell it.

يا أبا عمرو أين؟ واهّا لريح الجنة، أجده دون أحدٍ.

— البداية والنهاية ج ٤ ص ٢٠٣ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/1692>

English: "Abū 'Amr, where to? Ah, the scent of Paradise — I find it this side of Uḥud."

عبرت: He had made a promise in private, and he kept it on a day when nobody would have checked.

⚠ **Use this wording and not the famous one.** There is a much better-known version of Anas b. al-Naḍr^{رضي}'s words, and it is on the page at ١٩١ ص ٤ — but **Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله closes that report by calling it very strange, and says there is objectionable material in part of it.** The ṣaḥīḥ text is the one quoted above, at ٢٠٣ ص ٤. Say that one. If a listener recites the famous one back at you afterwards, agree that it is in the book, say where, and say what Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله wrote under it.

The year: the pages read do not fix it. سیر's chapter heading is «غزوة أحد وكانت في شوال». Say شوال ٥٣ as the standard placing, and do not defend it further.

29 • Known by his fingertips

When the fighting stopped they went out to identify the dead. They found Anas b. al-Naḍr^{رضي}, and there were more than eighty wounds on his body — sword, spear and arrow. His own family could not tell who he was.

His sister came, and she recognised her brother by his fingertips.

Say the count out loud and let it sit. Eighty. The room will not need it again for another three cards, and then it will need it very much.

His nephew, who was still a boy, later said that the verse of سورة الأحزاب was held to have come down about him and men like him.

﴿مِنَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ رِجَالٌ صَدَقُوا مَا عَاهَدُوا اللَّهَ عَلَيْهِ﴾ [الأحزاب: ٢٣]

— verse as quoted at ٢٠٣ ص ٤ ج ٤ · البدايه والنهائيه <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/1692>; the reference

«[الأحزاب: ٢٣]» is printed at ٤٠٧ ص ١ جلد السير، سير، <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/544>), not on

the البدايه page — cite both, or check a muṣḥaf before printing it

English: "Among the believers are men true to what they pledged to Allah."

عبرت: Some men are recognised by their faces, and some by what is left of their hands.

On the verse reference: the words are quoted at ٢٠٣ ص ٤ ج ٤ · البدايه; the printed reference «[الأحزاب: ٢٣]» is at ٤٠٧ ص ١ جلد السير — not on the البدايه page. **Cite both, or check a muṣḥaf before it goes on a slide.**

⚠ **The sister has a famous story attached to her name — the one about the Book of Allah and retaliation. It is not in البدايه, not in سير and not in الكامل: zero hits. Do not tell it, and do not allude to it.** She appears tonight for one reason and it is on the page: she knew her brother by his fingertips.

30 • «Do you see me dying in my bed?»

One card of domestic detail before the wall, and it is the card that makes the family real.

Anas^{رضي} came in on his brother and found him singing over his bow, and asked him how long that was going to go on. His brother answered with a question of his own, and then with a number: ninety-odd men killed in single combat, not counting what he had shared in with everyone else. In a second telling Anas^{رضي} puts it the other way round and asks him why he recites poetry when Allah has given him the Qur'an instead.

Two brothers in one house, and each thought the other needed correcting. Tell it lightly. It is the only place in the act where the room is allowed to smile.

أَتَرَانِي أَمُوتُ عَلَى فِرَاشِي؟ وَاللَّهِ لَقَدْ قَتَلْتُ بِضْعاً وَتِسْعِينَ.

— سير أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ١٩٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1624>

English: "Do you see me dying in my bed? By Allah, I have killed ninety-odd."

عبرت: Two brothers in one house, and each thought the other needed correcting.

The counts move — ninety-nine in one chain, ninety-odd in another, a hundred in a third.

Say "the reports give ninety-odd" and move on. Do not defend a number you did not need.

⚠ And **do not reach for the other famous figure attached to this man — the one in the hundreds of thousands. It is not in the safe list.** If it comes back at you on a slip, the honest answer is that our four books do not carry it.

31 · حذيفة الموت — al-Barā' over the wall

When Banū Ḥanīfa broke, one of their commanders called them into a walled garden and shut the gate behind them. Thousands inside, a solid wall, one gate.

al-Barā' b. Mālik^{رض} — the brother of Anas^{رض} — told the Muslims to throw him over it. They refused. He made them do it. They lifted him on a shield raised on spear-shafts until he topped the wall, and he went down among them alone, fought his way to the gate, and opened it.

On screen the gate is drawn shut. Then it opens **from the inside**.

يَا مَعْشَرَ الْمُسْلِمِينَ، أَتَقُونِي عَلَيْهِمْ فِي الْحَدِيقَةِ. فَقَالُوا: لَا تَفْعَلْ، فَقَالَ: وَاللَّهِ
لَتَطْرَحُنِّي عَلَيْهِمْ بِهَا! ... وَقَاتَلَ عَلَى الْبَابِ وَفَتَحَهُ لِلْمُسْلِمِينَ.

— الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢١٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/909>

English: "Company of Muslims — throw me over onto them into the garden. They said: we will not.

He said: By Allah, you will throw me onto them in it! ... And he fought at the gate and opened it for

the Muslims."

عبرت: One man asked to be thrown where nobody could follow him, and the whole army came in behind him through the gate he opened.

What it cost him — ١٩٦ ص ١ سير ج ١: «سِيرَ جُرْحًا فَجُرِحَ يَوْمَئِذٍ» — *some eighty-odd wounds, and خالد stayed a month over him treating them.* **He survived. Do not say he died there.** Ibn Khaldūn رحمه الله appears to list him among the killed; سير contradicts it, and سير is the page we are standing on.

Do not spend the wound count here. It is the first half of the pairing that card 32 completes, and it only detonates when it is set beside the eighty-odd wounds Anas b. al-Naḍr was carrying at أحد three cards ago. Tell this card as the gate, and let card 32 be the family.

32 • Over the wall at حديقة الموت

Now collect. Tell the same scene once more, in one breath, from the household's side — and this time say the family sentence, because it is the strongest thing in the evening and the whole of it is on the page:

"The man on that shield is Anas b. Mālik's ^{رضي} elder brother — the elder brother of the boy who served the Prophet ﷺ for ten years. Their uncle came off the field at أحد with the same count of wounds — and did not get up."

Nine years apart. The same house. The same number, eighty-odd. One of them was carried away dead and identified by his fingertips; the other walked out of a garden he had opened from the inside and خالد ^{رضي} sat over him for a month putting him back together.

Say the two counts next to each other and then stop. Do not tell the room what it means.

يَا مَعْشَرَ الْمُسْلِمِينَ، أَلْقُونِي عَلَيْهِمْ فِي الْحَدِيقَةِ. فَقَالُوا: لَا تَفْعَلْ، فَقَالَ: وَاللَّهِ
لَتَطْرَحُنِّي عَلَيْهِمْ بِهَا!

— ٢١٨ ص ٢ الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/909>

English: "Company of Muslims — throw me over onto them into the garden. They said: we will not. He said: by Allah, you will throw me onto them in it!"

عبرت: The gate that decided the day was opened from the inside, by one man who had to argue his own side into throwing him.

The pages: سير ج ١ ص ١٩٥ «أخو خادم النبي ﷺ أنس بن مالك» · البدايه ج ٦ ص ٣٩٦

«وكان الأكبر» · سير ج ١ ص ١٩٦ · البدايه ج ٤ ص ٢٠٣.

⚠ **Do not add that his mother is the woman who asked for Islam as her dower.** No page we have read names al-Barā's mother. What is established is the brother, and the brother is on the page. The sentence is just as strong without the addition, and adding it is the exact kind of small invention this course does not survive.

33 · The arrow he pulled out

Tell this one straight after the wall, as its pair.

Abū 'Aqīl^{رضي} was one of the chiefs of the أنصار and a man of Badr. At اليمامة an arrow hit him. He pulled it out himself. Then he bound himself up, took his sword, and went back to fighting. He fought until he was killed. When they came to him afterwards, they found many wounds on him.

Two men who would not be carried out. One survived with eighty-odd wounds and one did not survive at all, and neither of them asked anybody for anything.

أصابه سهم يوم اليمامة فنزعه، وتحزم وأخذ السيف وقاتل حتى قتل، فوجد به جراحات كثيرة.

— سير الخلفاء الراشدين) سير أعلام النبلاء — <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1208> · ص ٦٠

English: "An arrow struck him on the day of al-Yamāma and he pulled it out, bound himself up, took his sword and fought until he was killed — and many wounds were found on him."

عبرت: Nobody carried him out and nobody was asked to.

البدايه ج ٧ ص ٥٧ gives the same sentence.

⚠️⚠️ **The long famous version of this account — the night wound, the dead arm, the severed arm, the fourteen wounds, "who won?" — is NOT in any approved source.**

Tell only what is above. It is one of the most repeated stories about الإمامة and it is not on our pages, and a room that contains one person who knows where it comes from is a room where you have to be able to say why you did not tell it.

34 • "Lay me down between them"

The last of the household cards, and the one the act ends its field section on.

Struck down, Sālim رضى asked the men near him a question. What had become of Abū Ḥudhayfa رضى ? They told him he had been killed. He asked about one other man. They told him he was dead too.

Then he asked them for one thing, and it was the last thing he asked for.

فلما صرع قال لأصحابه: ما فعل أبو حذيفة؟ قالوا: قُتل، قال: فما فعل فلان؟

قالوا: قُتل، قال: فأضجعوني بينهما

— البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٥٠ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3196>

English: "When he was struck down he said to his companions: What has become of Abū Ḥudhayfa?

They said: He has been killed. He said: And what has become of so-and-so? They said: He has been

killed. He said: Then lay me down between the two of them."

عبرت: The freed slave's last request was to be put back beside the household that had taken him in.

⚠️ The second man is «فلان» in the source — *so-and-so*. **Do not name him.** And **no approved source says the two of them were buried in one grave.** He asked to be laid between them. That is the whole of what the page carries, and it is more than enough.

Telling it: this is the last thing said on the field tonight. Say it and stop. Do not add "رضي الله" as a flourish and do not add a sentence about brotherhood. Three seconds of nothing, then the next card.

35 • How they were found

One short card afterwards, and it must be told with its hedge intact.

In his notice on Sālim ^{رضي}, al-Dhahabī ^{رحمه الله} gives a report that he introduces with the words *it is said* — which is his way of passing something on without vouching for it. And elsewhere, in the roll of the day's martyrs, he lists the two of them first, and in that order: Abū Ḥudhayfa ^{رضي} بن 'Utba ^{العشمي}, and his freedman Sālim ^{رضي}, one of the reciters.

وَقِيلَ: إِنَّ سَالِمًا وَجَدَ هُوَ وَمَوْلَاهُ أَبُو حُذَيْفَةَ، رَأْسُ أَحَدِهِمَا عِنْدَ رِجْلَي الْآخَرِ

صَرِيحَيْنِ - رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا -

— سير أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ١٦٩ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1595>

English: "And it is said: Sālim was found, he and his patron Abū Ḥudhayfa, the head of one of them at the feet of the other, both struck down ^{رضي}."

عبرت: The books that list the dead of that day put the master and the freedman on one line.

⚠ **Carry the «وقيل» across into the delivery.** Say *it is said that...* — never *they were found*. The hedge is four words long and it is the difference between reporting and embroidering, and this is precisely the kind of card where a room notices which one you are doing.

36 • The mother at اليمامة

Before Musaylima is killed, the room needs to know in one page-cited scene what he was — so that the next card does not have to assert it.

He had a man named Ḥabīb b. Zayd ^{رضي} in his hands. He asked him whether he testified that Muḥammad ^{صلى الله عليه وسلم} was the Messenger of Allah, and Ḥabīb ^{رضي} said yes. Then he asked whether he testified that he, Musaylima, was a messenger of Allah — and Ḥabīb ^{رضي} said: *I do not hear*. So he began to cut him apart, one limb at a time, and Ḥabīb ^{رضي} never gave him more than that answer, until he died in his hands.

Ḥabīb's ^{رضي} mother was أم عمارة نسيبة بنت كعب رضي الله عنها, who had been at العقبة, at أحد, at الحديبية and at حنين. When the army marched to اليمامة, she went with it. Her hand was cut off there. She came back to المدينة covered in wounds — and أبو بكر ^{رضي}, while he was caliph, was

seen coming to her to ask after her.

فيقول: أتشهد أني رسول الله؟ فيقول: لا أسمع، فجعل يقطّعه عضوًا عضوًا حتى مات في يديه، لا يزيده على ذلك.

— البدايه والنهايه ج ٣ ص ٤٢٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/1402>

English: "Then he would say: Do you testify that I am the Messenger of Allah? And he would say:

I do not hear. So he began to cut him apart limb by limb until he died in his hands — and he never gave him more than that."

عبرت: He was not asked to say anything; he was asked to hear something, and he would not.

Telling it: do not describe the killing beyond the sentence the page gives. Say it once, plainly, and move to the mother. The card is hers.

⚠ **The wounds:** البدايه ج ٣ gives the hand and eleven wounds besides; سير ج ٢ ص ٢٨١ says twelve. **Give one figure with its caption, or say only "covered in wounds".** ⚠ And سير ج ٢ ص ٢٨٢ names her **other** son عبد الله بن زيد as the man who killed Musaylima — one of four accounts in the safe list. **Do not settle it**, tonight or on a slip.

37 • The death of Musaylima, and what Waḥshī^{رض} said afterwards

They got through to him standing in a gap in the wall. Waḥshī b. Ḥarb^{رض} — the man who had killed Ḥamza^{رض} at Uḥud, before he was a Muslim — threw his javelin and it went through him and out the other side; a second man struck him with a sword and he fell. A woman cried out from the fort above.

And afterwards, when Waḥshī^{رض} was asked about that battle, what he said was not about himself.

وَعَنْ وَحْشِيِّ، قَالَ: لَمْ أَرَّ قَطُّ أَصْبَرَ عَلَى الْمَوْتِ مِنْ أَصْحَابِ مُسَيْلِمَةَ، ثُمَّ ذَكَرَ أَنَّهُ
شَارَكَ فِي قَتْلِ مُسَيْلِمَةَ.

— (سير الخلفاء الراشدين) سير أعلام النبلاء · ص ٤٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1196>

English: "From Wahshī: I never saw men more steadfast in the face of death than Musaylima's companions — then he mentioned that he had a share in killing Musaylima."

عبرت: The man who killed their leader is the one the book quotes praising their courage.

△ **Sources differ on the second man.** الكامل ج ٢؛ البدايه ج ٧ ص ٣٤. **Say "a second man came up."** △ And **do not use the anonymous saying on the same سير page about the best and the worst of the people of the earth** — it makes a ranking claim the room will want to argue with, and you gain nothing. البدايه's plain apposition is better and safer: *Wahshī b. Ḥarb*, who had killed *Ḥamza*.

خالد walking the dead with the prisoner — البدايه ج ٧ ص ٣٥ — is the natural close of the act if you want one. He was shown a body and asked, is this him? «لَا، وَاللَّهِ هَذَا خَيْرٌ مِنْهُ». Then they came to a small sallow man, and خالد said: «قَبِّحْكَمُ اللَّهُ عَلَى اتِّبَاعِكُمْ هَذَا» — "May Allah disfigure you for following this."

38 • The same spear, at اليمامة

Sit this card directly beside the last one; it is the same throw seen from inside the man who made it.

When the army went out against Musaylima, Wahshī went with it, and he took the same spear he had used at Uhud. He saw a man standing in a gap in a wall and did not know who it was. He threw. An أنصاري came in from the other side with a sword.

He would never claim the kill for himself. What he said about the two throws of his life is on the page, and it is the reason this card exists.

فَرُبُّكَ أَعْلَمُ أَيُّنَا قَتَلَهُ، فَإِنْ كُنْتُ قَتَلْتُهُ، فَقَدْ قَتَلْتُ خَيْرَ النَّاسِ بَعْدَ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ،
وَقَتَلْتُ شَرَّ النَّاسِ

— البدايه والنهايه ج ٤ ص ١٨٥ · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/1674>

English: "Your Lord knows best which of us killed him. If I killed him, then I have killed the best of men after the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, and I have killed the worst of men."

عبرت: He never stopped weighing what he had done, and he never claimed more than he knew.

Telling it: read it once and do not gloss it. It is a man doing arithmetic on his own life in public, and it is unbearable, and any sentence you add to it makes it smaller. **What not to say:** do not use it to make a point about repentance. Let it stand as what it is — a report of what he said when he was asked.

39 • The witness against the enemy

One more sentence from the same man, and then the act turns for home.

Wahshī^{رضي} was asked about the men he had fought at اليمامة. He had spent his life among fighting men on both sides of a field. His verdict on Musaylima's army was one sentence, and it is not the sentence anyone expects from the winning side.

لَمْ أَرَ قَطُّ أَصْبَرَ عَلَى الْمَوْتِ مِنْ أَصْحَابِ مُسَيْلِمَةَ

— سير أعلام النبلاء، ج الخلفاء الراشدون ص ٤٨ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1196>

English: "I have never seen anyone more steadfast in the face of death than Musaylima's men."

عبرت: The books preserved the enemy's courage in the words of the man who fought them.

This is the card that stops the room laughing at Musaylima's followers, and it should be used for exactly that. The men who died in that garden were not comic. The book preserves their courage in the words of the man who fought them, and it does so on purpose.

40 • «He outstripped me to the two good things»

The news came back to المدينة. What عمر^{رضي} said when he heard it was not about the battle. It was a count of two things, and he had come second in both of them.

The room met Zayd b. al-Khaṭṭāb^{رضي} nine cards ago, holding a banner and refusing to speak. This is where he is paid for.

وقد قال عمر لما بلغه مقتل زيد بن الخطاب: سبقني إلى الحسين، أسلم قبلي،
واستشهد قبلي.

— البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٤٩ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3195>

English: "When the killing of Zayd b. al-Khaṭṭāb reached 'Umar he said: He outstripped me to the two good things — he accepted Islam before me, and he was martyred before me."

عبرت: The measure he used on his own brother was the one he used on himself.

وَحَزَنَ عَلَيْهِ عُمَرُ، وَكَانَ يَقُولُ: «عمر repeated: carries the second half as something سیر ج ١ ص ٢٩٨: «أَسْلَمَ قَبْلِي، وَاسْتُشْهِدَ قَبْلِي».

Telling it: the measure he used on his own brother is the one he used on himself, and the room will hear that without help. Do not help.

41 • The east wind

End the act here. Nothing moves on the map; if it is still up, leave المدينة sitting east of اليمامة and leave it there.

الصَّبَا is the east wind. عمر^{رضي} used to say the same thing about it, for years.

وَكَانَ يَقُولُ: مَا هَبَّتِ الصَّبَا إِلَّا وَأَنَا أَجِدُ رِيحَ زَيْدٍ.

— سیر أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ٢٩٨ — <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1724>

English: "He used to say: The east wind never blows but I find in it the scent of Zayd."

عبرت: The Companions' grief is recorded as carefully as their victories, and by the same men.

⚠ ٥٠ ص ج ٧ البدايه has a different wording — «ما هبت الصبا إلا ذكرني زيد بن الخطاب». Caption whichever you use, and **never print the سیر words under an Ibn Kathīr caption.**

△ And the remark that the wind came from the direction of اليمامة is **the speaker's own — the books do not say it**. If you want it, say "*and اليمامة is east of المدينة*" as a separate sentence about geography, in your own voice. Do not fold it into the quotation.

عبرت note: the Companions' grief is recorded as carefully as their victories, and by the same men. That is a fact about the books, and it is the right note to leave the act on.

Telling it: This act is now the heart of the evening and it is twenty-seven cards long. It is not all going to be told. Read all of it; deliver a spine through it.

The ★ cut here is cards 15, 21, 24, 28, 31, 32, 34, 37 and 41 — nine cards, about fourteen minutes, and they already make a whole act: the pairing, the rout, the shroud, the scent of Paradise, the wall from both sides, the freed slave's last request, the death of Musaylima, and عمرؓ in the east wind.

Hold the shape rather than the detail. Four households, in this order: *the appointment* (15) → *the house of 'Utba* (16–19) → *the rout* (20–21) → *the four men who rallied the line* (22–26) → *the will carried out after death* (27) → *the house of Mālik* (28–33) → *the last request* (34–36) → *Musaylima killed* (37–39) → عمرؓ *grieving* (40–41). If you can hold those nine phrases you can tell any subset of the act without getting lost.

Where to slow right down. Three places, and only three. Take a real pause after مَا هَكَذَا — three full seconds, count them. Take another after *lay me down between the two of them*. And take the longest one after the two counts of eighty-odd wounds in card 32, which is the single strongest thing in the evening: the uncle carried off أحد dead and known only by his fingertips, and nine years later the nephew carried off the wall of حديقة الموت alive, with خالدؓ sitting over him for a month. Say the two counts, say nothing else, and stop.

Where to speed up. Cards 16–19 are four short notices and should run as one movement of about two minutes, not four separate stops. Cards 25 and 26 are two sentences thirty seconds apart and belong together. Cards 38 and 39 are one man and can be one beat.

What not to say — and this act carries the whole of the evening's forbidden list. Six things:

1. أم سليمؓ is **not established as al-Barā' b. Mālik's mother**. What is established, and what is on the page, is that he is Anas b. Mālikؓ's brother. Say the brother. Do not say the mother, and do not add the story about a dower — no page we have read names al-Barā'ؓ's mother at all.

2. **الرَّبِيع بنت النضر's famous story — the Book of Allah and retaliation — is not in البداية, not in سير and not in الكامل. Zero hits.** She appears tonight for one reason, and it is on the page: she knew her brother by his fingertips. Do not tell the other story and do not allude to it.
3. **The figure of «ألف ألف» for al-Barā' is not in the safe list.** If it comes back at you, the honest answer is that our four books do not carry it.
4. **"And join me with Your Prophet ﷺ" is not part of his oath at تُسْتَر.** Both books stop at «واستشهدني». Do not complete a du‘ā’ the sources leave where they leave it.
5. **The popular wording of Anas b. al-Naḍr is in البداية ج ٤ ص ١٩١ — but Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله closes that report by calling it very strange and says there is objectionable material in part of it.** Use the ṣaḥīḥ text at البداية ج ٤ ص ٢٠٣, which is what card 28 quotes. If a listener recites the famous one at you, agree that it is in the book, say where, and say what Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله wrote beneath it.
6. **If the حنين dagger scene is told at all, tell it whole.** البداية ج ٤ ص ٥٨٩ does not end where the popular telling ends: it continues with أم سليم asking that the الطلقاء be killed and the Prophet ﷺ refusing her. End on *"Allah has sufficed and done well, O أم سليم"* — or do not tell it at all. Half of that scene is a different scene.

And the general cautions for the act: do not describe the killing, do not dwell on numbers here — they come in the next act, where they are the point — and do not let Musaylima become a joke. The sources make the men who followed him serious opponents, and Waḥshī's words in cards 37 and 39 are there precisely to stop the room laughing at them.

If a slip asks — "how can a man who killed Ḥamza رضي be given?" He accepted Islam. The books name him with the honorific and quote him with respect, and the quotation the deck uses is him praising the courage of the men he had just fought. That is the whole answer, and the page carries it.

If a slip asks about Sālim رضي and adoption — that is a question of fiqh, it belongs to the fuqahā', it is not on any card tonight, and you are reading a history book. Say exactly that, warmly, and offer the fifteen minutes afterwards.

If a slip asks "who actually killed Musaylima?" — four accounts sit inside the safe list, and one of them names أم عمارة رضي الله عنها's other son. **Do not settle it.** Say the books give more than one account, name that as a normal feature of a battle told by many witnesses, and move on.

ACT 4 • What اليمامة cost, and what it produced

12 AH

42 • The number nobody can give

This is the honesty beat, and it has to come before the collection is narrated. It is also the card that forecloses the likeliest hostile slip of the evening.

After أبو بكر, اليمامة ordered the Qur'an collected, and the reason the books give is that the killing had run hot among the reciters. That is the phrase all three of them use.

What none of them gives is a number. Ibn Kathīr's رحمه الله own summary of the Muslim dead is four hundred and fifty — and he says in the same breath that he is counting bearers of the Qur'an, Companions and others together in that one figure.

So we know why the Qur'an was collected. We do not know how many reciters died. We only know that it was enough.

Ask the room first: *how many men who had the whole Qur'an by heart died that day? What would you guess?* Take the guesses. Then give the honest answer: the books do not say.

وذلك بعد ما استَحَرَّ القُتْلُ في القُرْأاء يوم اليمامة كما ثبت به الحديث في صحيح البخاري.

صحيح البخاري ٤٩٨٦ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3225> · البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٧٩ —

English: "...and that was after the killing had run hot among the reciters on the day of al-Yamāma, as the ḥadīth in Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī establishes."

عبرت: They did not wait to find out how much had been lost before they secured what was left.

△ The figures the safe list does give run from 58 to more than 1,080, and none of them is a count of reciters. △ Anyone who says "450 reciters" has misread البدايه ج ٧ ص ٥٥. If that number comes back at you on a slip, that is the answer, and it is a strong one — you know the page it comes from and you know what it actually counts.

43 • The killing ran hot among the reciters

At اليمامة the ردة was broken and Musaylima was killed. Then Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله stops the narrative and counts the cost — which is unusual, and worth telling the room *as* unusual. The dead in the garden and in the battle at close to ten thousand, though he adds that some say twenty-one thousand. The Muslim dead at six hundred, or five hundred. And then he writes *and Allah knows best*.

Among the fallen were men who carried the Qur'an in their memories. His phrase for it is اشتدَّ as استحرَّ — the killing *ran hot* among the reciters. The editor glosses استحرَّ as اشتدَّ, grew fierce.

وقتل من المسلمين ستمئة، وقيل: خمسمئة، فإله أعلم، وفيهم من سادات الصحابة،
وأعيان الناس من يُذكر بعد

— البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٣٥ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3181>

English: "Six hundred of the Muslims were killed — and it is said five hundred — and Allah knows

best. Among them were leaders of the Companions and men of standing, who will be named later."

عبرت: A generation can carry something priceless and never notice how thin the carrying is until some of it is dropped.

Dates: Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله has اليمامة begun in ١١٥ هـ and finished in ١٢٥ هـ, with «المشهور» at ربيع ١٢ هـ; Ibn al-Athīr رحمه الله places it in ١١٥ هـ. Say the span, not a single month. ⚠ **Never put a number of قراء on the slide or in the room — none of our sources gives one.**

44 • Take the Qur'ān from four

One card between the cost and the collection, and it closes the household strand.

Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله, writing Sālim's ^{رض} death notice, gives the reason the ummah remembered him. He was one of four men the Prophet ﷺ named when he told the Companions from whom to take the Qur'an.

One of the four was a freed slave of the house of Abū Ḥudhayfa ^{رض} — and he had just died holding a banner at اليمامة, which is exactly the point the next card is about to make.

وهو أحد الأربعة الذين قال فيهم رسول الله ﷺ: "استقرئوا القرآن من أربعة" فذكر
منهم سالمًا مولى أبي حذيفة

— <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3196> · البدايه والنهائيه ج ٧ ص ٥٠ —

English: "And he is one of the four of whom the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: 'Take the Qur'ān from four' — and he mentioned Sālim, the freedman of Abū Ḥudhayfa, among them."

عبرت: Standing in this matter was decided by what a man carried, and by nothing else about him.

⚠ **Slide and platform rule.** Ibn Kathīr's رحمه الله own text quotes only the opening clause. **If the four names are said or shown they must be attributed to صحيح مسلم ٢٤٦٤**, as in the editor's note on البدايه ج ٧ ص ٥٠ — **never to Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله**. The safest delivery is to say *one of four*, and not to list the four at all.

45 · "How can we do a thing the Messenger of Allah ﷺ did not do?"

This is the still point of the evening. No map, no movement, المدينة only.

After أبو بكر، الإمامة، sent for زيد بن ثابت رضي الله عنه. Introduce him here, in one breath, because the room needs to know why him: a young man of بنو النجار, eleven years old when the Prophet ﷺ arrived in المدينة, who had memorised seventeen سور before he was introduced, who learned the Jews' script in a fortnight because the Prophet ﷺ asked him to, and who had written the revelation down as it came.

أبو بكر رضي الله عنه told him to go and find the whole Qur'an and gather it. And زيد رضي الله عنه balked — and his objection is the most serious objection there is, which is exactly why the room should hear it in his own words rather than yours.

فَقُلْتُ: كَيْفَ تَفْعَلُونَ شَيْئًا لَمْ يَفْعَلْهُ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ - صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ -. قَالَ: هُوَ -وَاللَّهِ- حَيْرٌ. فَلَمْ يَزَلْ أَبُو بَكْرٍ يُرَاجِعُنِي حَتَّى شَرَحَ اللَّهُ صَدْرِي لِلَّذِي شَرَحَ لَهُ صَدْرُ أَبِي بَكْرٍ وَعُمَرُ

— سيرة أعلام النبلاء ج ٢ ص ٤٣١ - <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/2411>

English: "I said: 'How will you do a thing the Messenger of Allah ﷺ did not do?' He said: 'By

Allah, it is good.' And أبو بكر did not stop coming back to me until Allah opened my breast to

that to which He had opened the breasts of أبو بكر and عمر."

عبرت: The men closest to the Prophet ﷺ were the most afraid of adding to what he ﷺ left — which is exactly why what they did add can be trusted.

46 • Parchment, shoulder-blades, palm-stalks, and the breasts of men

There was no volume to copy from. That is the sentence the room will not have understood before tonight. زيد ^{رضي} had to track it down — his own verb is تَتَبَّعَ, to follow a thing up piece by piece — and gather it off whatever the Companions had written it on: strips of parchment, the flat shoulder-blades of animals, the bare stalks of palm branches, thin white stones, and out of the memories of the men who had it by heart. Then it was one set of صحف, in one place, for the first time.

فَكُنْتُ أَتَتَبَّعُ الْقُرْآنَ، أَجْمَعُهُ مِنَ الرِّقَاعِ، وَالْأَكْتَفِ، وَالْعُسْبِ، وَصُدُورِ الرِّجَالِ.

— سيرة أعلام النبلاء ج ٢ ص ٤٣١ - <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/2411>

English: "So I began to track down the Qur'an, gathering it from the parchments, the shoulder-blades, the palm-stalks, and the breasts of men."

عبرت: Preservation is not one heroic act; it is somebody doing a careful, unglamorous job properly.

A small source note worth having: Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله at ص ٧٩ names اللّخاف — the thin white stones — where الذّبي رحمه الله names الرّقاء. If you want both, say so and cite both. Do not silently merge them.

Telling it: About five minutes, and this is the act to protect at all costs — if the evening runs badly late you cut from acts 5, 6 and 7, never from here. The rhythm is a cost, then a consequence. Do not join them with a lesson; let the room join them.

The ★ cut here is cards 42, 45 and 46, and card 42 must go first, before either of the others. It is the honesty beat: the books say *why* the Qur'an was gathered and none of them says how many reciters died. Ask the room to guess, take the guesses, and then say plainly that the answer is not in the books. That thirty seconds is what protects the rest of the act — and it forecloses the likeliest hostile slip of the whole evening.

Cards 43 and 44 are the two short ones. Card 43 is Ibn Kathīr's رحمه الله count of the dead, which is worth telling *as* unusual — he stops the narrative to count, and then writes *and Allah knows best*. Card 44 closes the household strand: the man from إصطخر who had just died holding a banner was one of four the Prophet ﷺ named to take the Qur'an from. Play it immediately before card 45 and the collection lands differently.

The one piece of stagecraft in the whole evening sits at the end of card 46: say the four things once, slowly, then ask the room to say them back. Parchment. Shoulder-blades. Palm-stalks. The breasts of men. That is the line people repeat in the car.

What not to say: do not say or imply the Qur'an was at risk of being lost, **do not put a number on the قراء who died** — that is card 42's entire job and you undo it in one sentence — and do not stray toward عثمان رضي's later copies; that belongs to a later session, and mixing them is how rooms get confused. On card 44, **if the four names are said at all they are attributed to صحیح مسلم ٢٤٦٤**, never to Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله. The safest delivery is *one of four*, and no list.

If a slip asks — "so the Qur'an was collected after the Prophet ﷺ?" The page is open and it answers itself. زيد رضي raised exactly that objection first, and raised it as an objection. أبو بكر رضي did not overrule him with authority; he kept coming back to him until زيد رضي was convinced. What was gathered was what the Companions already had written and memorised, checked and put in one place. Read the two quotations and stop there. Do not go into methodology, and do not answer a question about the 'Uthmānic copies tonight — say warmly that it belongs to a later session.

ACT 5 • Arabia whole again

12 AH

47 • دارين — into the water

The beaten took ship for دارين, an anchorage a day and a night out from the البحرين shore. This looks like an escape, and the room will assume it was.

al-‘Alā’^{رض} did not chase them straight away. He first wrote to the Muslims of Bakr b. Wā’il to sit on every road and close the land behind him. Only then did he bring his men to the water's edge — where ships would have been too slow — and tell them what he intended.

قَدْ أَرَأَكُمُ اللَّهُ مِنْ آيَاتِهِ فِي الْبَرِّ لَتَعْتَبِرُوا بِهَا فِي الْبَحْرِ، فَانْهَضُوا إِلَى عَدُوِّكُمْ وَاسْتَعْرِضُوا
الْبَحْرَ.

— ٢٢٤ ص · الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/915>

English: "Allah has shown you of His signs on land so that you may take heed of them at sea. Rise against your enemy, and go straight across the sea."

عبرت: He closed the roads behind the enemy before he opened one in front of himself.

Both books describe the crossing the same way — «المشون على مثل رملةٍ دمثةٍ فوقها ماء لا يغمر» (البدايه ج ٧ ص ٤٠) — out and back in a single day, with nothing lost in the water except one man's horse-fodder, which al-‘Alā’^{رض} went back and brought him. ٤٠ ص ج ٧ البدايه prints the du‘ā’ they said going in. And afterwards: «وَصَرَبَ الْإِسْلَامُ فِيهَا بِجَرَانِهِ» (الكامل ج ٢ ص ٢٢٤).

48 • "Do not let me see you until you have proved yourself"

Two short cards on ‘Ikrima^{رض} before the war is summed up — and the room met his name in card 1, commanding the left wing of the Meccan cavalry at Uḥud.

أبو بكر^{رض} gave him one of the eleven banners and sent him against Musaylima, with Shuraḥbīl^{رض} following. ‘Ikrima^{رض} attacked before Shuraḥbīl^{رض} arrived, wanting the victory on his own, and was badly handled.

The caliph wrote to him. And then he sent him on: first to عُمان, then to مهرة, then to اليمن and حضرموت. He fought in every one of them.

وَكَتَبَ إِلَيْهِ الصِّدِّيقُ يُلُومُهُ عَلَى تَسْرُعِهِ، قَالَ: لَا أَرَيْتَكَ وَلَا أَسْمَعَنَّ بِكَ إِلَّا بَعْدَ بَلَاءٍ

— البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٤١ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3187>

English: "al-Ṣiddīq wrote blaming him for his haste, and said: let me not see you, and let me not hear of you, except after you have proved yourself."

عبرت: He was corrected and kept, not corrected and dropped.

Telling it: the letter is sharp and the room will expect a dismissal to follow it. There is none — the next sentence on the page sends him to 'Umān. Read the rebuke and the posting one after the other, without a pause between them, and the card makes itself.

49 • The muṣḥaf against his face

And one habit, from the end of his life.

Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله records two things about 'Ikrima^{رضي} in his obituary notice. The first is something he used to do. The second is something other people used to say about him. Imām Aḥmad رحمه الله later cited the first as evidence in a question of law.

وَكَانَ يُقَبِّلُ الْمُصْحَفَ وَيَبْكِي وَيَقُولُ: كَلَامُ رَبِّي، كَلَامُ رَبِّي ... وَيَقَالُ: إِنَّهُ لَا
يُعْرِفُ لَهُ ذَنْبٌ بَعْدَ مَا أَسْلَمَ

— البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ١٢٧ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3273>

English: "He used to kiss the muṣḥaf and weep and say: my Lord's speech, my Lord's speech ... And it is said that no sin is known of him after he accepted Islam."

عبرت: The son of Abū Jahl kissed the Book and wept over it. (*Kissed* — «يُقَبِّلُ» — is Ibn Kathīr's wording, which is what this card cites. "Held it to his face" is al-Dārimī's wording and must not be said under a Bidāya caption. See §3.6.)

⚠ **Use the verb the caption carries.** «يُقَبِّلُ» — *kissed* — is Ibn Kathīr's رحمه الله wording, and it is what this card cites. "Held it to his face" is al-Dārimī's رحمه الله wording and **must not be said under a** البدايه **caption.** Two wordings, two books, one page reference each — keep them apart.

50 • Ṭulayḥa comes back

This is the payoff of the first half, and it is the best hands-up of the evening. Ask it exactly like this: "Last time we left Ṭulayḥa riding away from بُرَاخَةَ with his wife. What do you think became of him?" Take answers. They will be wrong, and they will be confident.

He did not die at بُرَاخَةَ. He escaped to الشام and lived among the Ghassānids. Then he returned to Islam. He went to Mecca for 'umra. Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله says twice that he could not bring himself to face أَبُو بَكْرٍ.

Then he came to greet عُمَرُ. عُمَرُ named the two men he had killed at بُرَاخَةَ and told him to get away from him. Ṭulayḥa answered — and the answer is on the page, and so is what عُمَرُ did about it.

اغْرُبْ عَنِّي فَإِنَّكَ قَاتِلُ الرَّجُلَيْنِ الصَّالِحَيْنِ، عُكَّاشَةُ بْنُ مُحْصَنٍ، وَثَابِتِ بْنِ أَقْرَمَ،
فَقَالَ: يَا أَمِيرَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ هُمَا رَجُلَانِ أَكْرَمَهُمَا اللَّهُ عَلَى يَدَيَّ وَلَمْ يُهْنِي بِأَيْدِيهِمَا.
فَأَعْجَبَ عُمَرُ كَلَامَهُ وَرَضِيَ عَنْهُ

— ٢٤٢ ج ٧ · البدايه والنهايه · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3388>

English: "'Get away from me — you are the killer of the two righteous men, 'Ukkāsha b. Miḥṣan and Thābit b. Aqram.' He said: Commander of the Believers, they are two men whom Allah honoured at my hands, and He did not disgrace me at theirs. And 'Umar was pleased by his words, and was satisfied with him."

عبرت: He did not deny what he had done, and he did not excuse it either.

Telling it: two minutes, and do not rush the last clause. The card ends on عُمَرُ being pleased with him, and that is the sentence the room walks out of the first half holding.

What not to say: do not call it a change of heart, do not use the word redemption, and do not compare him to anyone. He did not deny what he had done and he did not excuse it either — that is the whole of it, and it is better than anything that could be said about it.

Dating: at the end of أَبُو بَكْرٍ's caliphate or just after — **the books differ, so say "at the end of the caliphate, or just after".**

51 • What Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله says the whole war was

When he finishes the whole account, Ibn Kathīr رحمه الله stops and sums it up himself — and his summary is not the one the room is expecting. He does not describe a conquest. He says there was no region of Arabia in which some people did not turn, and that أبو بكر [ؓ] sent armies and commanders **to be a support to whichever believers were already in that region**. The fifth of the spoils came back to المدينة and was spent among the people. And it went on that way until there was nobody left in the peninsula except people in obedience and people under a covenant of protection — like the people of نجران, who had sent a delegation to renew theirs while Muslim tribes were breaking theirs.

Let the author have the last word on his own material. Read it as his verdict, not yours.

ما من ناحية من جزيرة العرب إلا وحصلَ في أهلها ردَّةٌ لبعض الناس، فبعثَ
الصدِّيقُ إليهم جيوشًا وأمراءَ يكونون عونًا لمن في تلك الناحية من المؤمنين ... ولم
يزل الأمر كذلك حتى لم يبق بجزيرة العرب إلا أهل طاعة لله ولرسوله، وأهل ذمة من
الصدِّيق، كأهل نجران وما جرى مجراهم والله الحمد.
وعامة ما وقع من هذه الحروب كان في أواخر سنة إحدى عشرة وأوائل سنة ثنتي
عشرة.

— <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3189> · البدايه والنهائيه ج ٧ ص ٤٣

English: "There was no region of the Arabian peninsula in which apostasy did not occur among some of its people; so al-Ṣiddīq sent them armies and commanders to be a support to whichever believers

were in that region ... And matters continued so until there remained in the peninsula none but

people obedient to Allah and His Messenger, and people under al-Ṣiddīq's protection, such as the

people of Najrān. The general run of these wars was in the last part of the year 11 and the first

part of the year 12."

عبرت: The armies were sent to hold up people who were already standing, and the whole thing was over in a little more than a year.

52 • ★ The call does not add numbers; it removes rivalry

Ask the question before you answer it, because everyone in the room is already holding it: a peninsula that has just fragmented is moving against two empires within two years. How?

Ibn Khaldūn رحمه الله's answer does not multiply anyone's numbers. He says a religious call takes away the rivalry and the mutual envy that exist among people bound by kin, and points them all one way. Once that happens nothing stands in front of them — because the direction is one, the object is equal in every eye, and they will die for it. He names the conquests as his own example.

والسبب في ذلك ... أن الصبغة الدينية تذهب بالتنافس والتحاسد الذي في أهل
العصبية وتفرد الوجهة
إلى الحق فإذا حصل لهم الاستبصار في أمرهم لم يقف لهم شيء لأن الوجهة واحدة
والمطلوب متساو عندهم
وهم مستميتون عليه

— <https://shamela.ws/book/12320/196> · تاريخ ابن خلدون ج ١ ص ١٩٨

English: "The reason for it ... is that the religious colouring takes away the rivalry and mutual

envy that are in people of عصبية, and makes their direction single, towards the truth.

Then, once

clear sight in their affair is theirs, nothing stands in their way — because the direction is one,

the object is equal in all their eyes, and they will die for it."

عبرت: What changed in Arabia was not how many men there were, but which way they were all facing.

⚠ **Say his name, and say "as he reads it".** Ibn Khaldūn رحمه الله never wrote this about the ردة. Joining his chapter to the year eleven is our doing, and the slide must show that it is. This is the one place tonight where you are offering an interpretation rather than a report, and the room must be able to hear the difference.



[WORKSHEET — 90 seconds, silent] Mark three places on the blank map. Write the years into three of the six timeline boxes. **Say nothing while they write.**

Telling it: About six minutes, and it ends the first half. **The ★ cut here is cards 50, 51 and 52**, in that order: Ṭulayḥa ^{رضي} comes back, Ibn Kathīr ^{رحمه الله} sums the war up, and Ibn Khaldūn ^{رحمه الله} explains what changed. Cards 47, 48 and 49 are the three that go if you are long — and دارين can always be told in three sentences: roads closed, water crossed, back the same day.

Card 50 is the payoff of the whole first half and it is the best hands-up of the evening. The room last saw Ṭulayḥa riding away from بُراخة calling over his shoulder. Ask them what became of him, take answers, and let them be wrong. Then tell it: he came back to Islam, went for ‘umra, and stood in front of ^{رضي} عمر and neither denied nor excused what he had done. **He must not be left fleeing.** If the evening is running so late that only one card in this act survives, it is this one.

Card 51 stays too — it is Ibn Kathīr's ^{رحمه الله} own verdict on his own material, and it is what keeps the ردة section from sounding like a conquest narrative.

Then the worksheet, and the hardest instruction of the night: *stop talking*. Ninety seconds of silence feels like five minutes on stage. Do not fill it, do not explain the worksheet twice, do not walk about. Stand still, let them write, watch the clock — that silence is what makes the second half feel like a fresh start.

What not to say: do not draw any present-day parallel from card 52. None. The moment عصبية becomes a comment on anything current you have started adjudicating, and this room holds settled views. State it as Ibn Khaldūn ^{رحمه الله}'s reading of the past, and move on. And on card 50, **do not use the word redemption, do not call it a change of heart, and do not compare him to anybody.** The page's own last clause — that ^{رضي} عمر was pleased with what he said — is stronger than any framing.

If a slip asks — "why is Ibn Khaldūn ^{رحمه الله} being quoted here?" He is used in this course for judgement and framing only, never as the authority for a date, a name or a number, and he is always named. Tonight he supplies one explanation, labelled as his, of something the narrative sources report but do not explain. That is exactly the use he is admitted for.

ACT 6 • Outward

12–13 AH

53 • The order to Iraq

Here the map stops being Arabia. The first arrow leaves the peninsula — from اليمامة east to the lower Euphrates — and for the rest of the series Arabia is no longer the whole board. Mark that moment for the room.

خالد^{رض} had just finished اليمامة when a letter came from المدينه. It did not say "conquer Iraq." It said: come at Iraq from its lower end. Call the people to God. If they answer, they are Muslims — what is yours is theirs. If they refuse, take the jizya. If they refuse that, fight.

And then two restrictions that are easy to miss and are the reason this card is in the evening at all. Do not compel any man to march with you. And do not use any man who apostatised, even if he has come back.

وَأَنْ يَتَأَلَّفَ النَّاسَ وَيَدْعُوهُمْ إِلَى اللَّهِ ﷻ، فَإِنْ أَجَابُوا وَإِلَّا أَخَذَ مِنْهُمْ الْجِزْيَةَ فَإِنْ امْتَنَعُوا
عَنْ ذَلِكَ قَاتِلْهُمْ،
وَأَمْرُهُ أَنْ لَا يُكْرَهَ أَحَدًا عَلَى الْمَسِيرِ مَعَهُ، وَلَا يَسْتَعِينُ بِمَنْ ارْتَدَّ عَنِ الْإِسْلَامِ وَإِنْ كَانَ
[قَدْ] عَادَ إِلَيْهِ

— البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٦٢ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3208>

English: "...that he should win the people over and call them to God; if they answered, well, and

if not, take the jizya from them; and if they refused that, fight them. And he ordered him not to

compel anyone to march with him, and not to make use of any man who had apostatised from Islam,

even if he had returned to it."

عبرت: A state that has just won a civil war and still refuses to conscript the defeated is telling you what it thinks it is for.

54 • أبو بكر walks beside the stirrup

One short card inside the march north, and it rhymes with the first act deliberately — the room watched him walk an army out on foot in card 5, and here he is doing it again two years later.

Yazīd b. Abī Sufyān^{رضي} was one of four commanders أبو بكر appointed for the Syrian campaign. He was called Yazīd al-Khayr. He was the brother of أم^{رضي} Ḥabīb, the Mother of the Believers. His father had led the army at Uḥud — which the room has known since card 1.

When أبو بكر tied his standard for him, he did not stand and watch him ride out. Al-Dhahabī رحمه الله says plainly why.

عَقَدَ لَهُ أَبُو بَكْرٍ، وَمَشَى مَعَهُ تَحْتَ رِكَابِهِ يُسَائِرُهُ، وَيُودِّعُهُ، وَيُوصِيهِ، وَمَا ذَاكَ إِلَّا لِشَرَفِهِ، وَكَمَالِ دِينِهِ

— سير أعلام النبلاء ج ١ ص ٣٢٩ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1755>

English: "Abū Bakr tied his standard for him and walked beside him under his stirrup, keeping pace with him, seeing him off and instructing him — and that was only for his standing and the completeness of his religion."

عبرت: The caliph walked and the commander rode, and neither of them thought it strange.

Telling it: forty seconds. The card is the last collection on card 1's three names, and it is worth saying out loud that the room has now seen all of them: خالد^{رضي} commanding, 'Ikrima^{رضي} sent from front to front, and Abū Sufyān's son given a standard by the caliph, who then walked beside his stirrup. **What not to say:** nothing about the Umayyads. That is sessions 4 and 5, and reaching for it here costs you the evening's discipline for no gain.

Certainty: the year is the standard placing for the sending of the Syrian armies, ١٣٥ — **(to verify)**. Say "when the Syrian armies were being sent out" rather than a month.

55 • The march across the waterless desert

This is the map moment of the second half. A line strikes north-west out of Iraq at Qurāqir, crosses blank desert with no road on it, and comes out at Suwā and Tadmur — behind the Roman armies.

The commanders in Syria wrote to أبو بكر^{رضي} asking for reinforcement and telling him what the Romans had gathered at the Yarmūk. He wrote back to خالد^{رضي} in Iraq: put a deputy over Iraq, bring the men you have to Syria, and when you reach them you are the commander over them. خالد^{رضي} set off at once — but not by any road. He chose the Samāwa, waterless country.

His guide was Rāfi' b. 'Umayra al-Tā'i, and Rāfi' told him plainly it could not be done with cavalry and baggage: a lone rider fears that road. خالد^{رضي} said he had no choice; he had to come out behind the Romans.

So they prepared, and the preparation is the part worth telling slowly, because nobody in the room will have heard it. The strongest camels were made thirsty, then watered twice over, their lips cut and their mouths bound so they could not chew and lose the water. Every day they opened the bellies of ten of them and watered the horses from what was inside.

On the last stretch Rāfi', whose eyes were bad, asked the men whether they could see a box-thorn bush the height of a seated man. They said no. He said: then by God you are dead, and I am dead with you. They looked again. The bush was there, cut down to a stump. They dug at its root and found the spring.

وَاللَّهِ مَا وَرَدْتُ هَذَا الْمَاءَ قَطُّ إِلَّا مَرَّةً وَاحِدَةً مَعَ أَبِي وَأَنَا غُلَامٌ

— ٢٥٣ ص ٢ في التاريخ الكامل · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/944>

English: "By God, I have come to this water only once in my life — with my father, when I was a boy."

عبرت: The march was survived on preparation and on one man's memory; neither was an accident.

Length of the march: البدايه says nine days; الكامل and سير say five nights. **Say both**, in one breath, and move on. Saying both costs four seconds and buys you the room's trust for the rest of the evening.

56 . خالد^{رضي} hands the command round

The Muslim armies came to the Yarmūk still divided — four commanders, each over his own men, nobody over all of them. The Roman camp was at al-Wāqūṣa with a ravine at its back and the Muslim line sitting across the only road out.

On the morning of the battle خالد^{رضي} stood up and made a proposal. He did not ask for the command. He proposed that they pass it round: one of us today, another tomorrow, another the day after, until every one of us has held it — *and let me have today*. They made him commander, expecting the arrangement to last a long time.

It lasted one day.

إن هذا يوم من أيام الله، لا ينبغي فيه الفخر ولا البغي ... فتعالوا فلنتعاور الإمارة
فليكن عليها بعضنا
اليوم والآخر غدًا والآخر بعد غد، حتى يتأمر كلكم، ودعوني اليوم أليكم

— البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٨٩ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3235>

English: "This is a day of God's days — there should be no boasting in it and no aggression ...

So come, let us take the command in turn: one of us today, another tomorrow,
another the day

after, until every one of you has commanded. And let me have charge of you today."

عبرت: The man who asked for one day got the day; a man who had demanded the whole command might have got neither.

57 • "Armies are made many by victory"

خالد^{رضي} had come in from Iraq and was looking at the Roman lines. A Christian Arab standing near him said out loud what everyone there could see: how many the Romans are, and how few the Muslims. The answer he got had nothing to do with counting.

ويلك، أتخوّفني بالروم؟ وإنما تكثر الجنود بالنصر، وتقل بالخذلان لا بعدد الرجال

— البدايه والنهايه ج ٧ ص ٩٢ — <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3238>

English: "Woe to you — are you frightening me with the Romans? Armies are made many by victory
and few by abandonment, not by the number of men."

عبرت: Counting the enemy is useful; being governed by the count is not.

This is the right place to be honest about numbers in front of the room, and it will do you credit. Ask them to guess the two army sizes; take three guesses; then show that the books themselves give three different answers, and say why that happens with pre-modern figures. Then put the caveat line on screen under the numbers panel and leave it there.

Telling it: About six minutes, and the pace should pick up — you have come out of a battlefield and a still point, and this act is movement. Four beats: the letter, the stirrup, the desert, the command.

This is the one act with no ★ card in it at all, and that is deliberate. In the recommended forty-five-minute cut the evening goes from the worksheet straight to the deathbed, and the whole of Iraq and الشام rolls forward into session 3 — which is where the Yarmūk properly belongs anyway (`DECISIONS.md` #20: overflow rolls, it is never compressed). Read the act; be ready to tell it; and if the clock says no, drop it whole rather than gutting it. A two-minute version of the desert march is worse than no desert march.

If you do have the time, **spend it on card 55**; the camels and the box-thorn bush are the kind of detail nobody forgets, and they are on the page. Card 54 is forty seconds and it is worth keeping even in a shortened act, because it is the last collection on card 1: خالد^{رضي} commanding, 'Ikrima^{رضي} sent from front to front, and Abū Sufyān's son given a standard by the caliph — who then walked beside his stirrup. Cards 56 and 57 go before card 55 does.

What not to say: do not narrate the battle of the Yarmūk. It is not tonight's material, the evening has to reach a deathbed, and starting a battle you cannot finish is the fastest way to lose the last ten minutes. And on card 54, **say nothing at all about the Umayyads.** That is sessions 4 and 5. Reaching for it here buys nothing and costs the evening its discipline.

If a slip asks — "was this aggression? Why march on Iraq at all?" Do not defend and do not apologise; read the letter. It sets an order: call them, then the jizya, then fighting only if both are refused. And it contains two restrictions that an aggressor would not write — no man is compelled to march, and no man who had apostatised is used, even if he had returned. That is what the page says. Whether that satisfies a modern objection is not a question you settle from a lectern, and you can say so pleasantly.

ACT 7 • He dies

13 AH

Nothing moves on the map for the whole of this act. Say that out loud when you get here — the map stops, and the last twenty minutes of the man's life are all indoors. It changes the temperature of the room.

58 • He asks عبد الرحمن بن عوف^{رض} about عمر^{رض}

He called عبد الرحمن بن عوف^{رض} in and asked him to tell him about عمر^{رض}. عبد الرحمن^{رض} said what everyone in المدينة already thought: he is better than you think — except there is harshness in him.

أبو بكر^{رض} did not argue with the description. He explained it. *He is hard because he sees me being soft. When I was angry with a man, عمر^{رض} showed me leniency; when I was gentle with a man, عمر^{رض} showed me severity. Put the office in his hands and much of that will go.*

فَقَالَ: إِنَّهُ أَفْضَلُ مِنْ رَأْيِكَ إِلَّا أَنَّهُ فِيهِ غِلْظَةٌ. فَقَالَ أَبُو بَكْرٍ: ذَلِكَ لِأَنَّهُ يَرَانِي رَقِيقًا،
وَلَوْ أَفْضَى الْأَمْرُ إِلَيْهِ لَتَرَكَ كَثِيرًا مِمَّا هُوَ عَلَيْهِ

— ٢٦٦ ص ٢ في التاريخ ج ٢ - الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ ص ٢٦٦ <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/957>

English: "He said: he is better than your opinion of him — except that there is harshness in

him. Abū Bakr said: that is because he sees me being gentle. If the affair passed to him he would

leave much of what he is now."

عبرت: A man's edge is often the shape of the gap he thinks he is filling.

59 • "I have not appointed a relative over you"

The document was finished and he ordered it read out. The people gathered. The letter went with a freedman of his, and عمر^{رض} walked beside him telling the crowd to be quiet and listen. It was read. They said: we hear and we obey.

Then أبو بكر^{رض} looked out over them himself and asked them a question — *are you content with the man I have appointed?* And then he told them the thing nobody had asked him.

أَتَرْضُونَ بِمَنْ اسْتَخْلَفْتُ عَلَيْكُمْ؟ فَإِنِّي مَا اسْتَخْلَفْتُ عَلَيْكُمْ ذَا قَرَابَةٍ، وَإِنِّي قَدْ
اسْتَخْلَفْتُ عَلَيْكُمْ عُمَرَ فَاسْمَعُوا لَهُ وَأَطِيعُوا، فَإِنِّي وَاللَّهِ مَا أَلَوْتُ مِنْ جُهِدِ الرَّأْيِ.

— ٢٦٧ ص · الكامل في التاريخ ج ٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/958>

English: "Are you content with the one I have appointed over you? For I have not appointed over you a relative of mine. I have appointed 'Umar over you, so hear him and obey — for by God, I have not fallen short of the utmost of my judgement."

عبرت: He had a son and a family in that city, and he named the hardest man in it instead.

60 • The list of what he owned

He called عائشة ^{رضي}. He told her that since the day he took charge of the Muslims' affair he had not eaten a dinar or a dirham of theirs — only the coarsest of their food, only the roughest of their clothing.

Then he listed what was in the house that belonged to the Muslims and not to him. An Abyssinian servant. A camel used for carrying water. The worn nap of one blanket. *When I die, send them to عمر*. She did.

Read the list slowly. Three items. The room will be counting them.

وليس عندنا من فيء المسلمين شيء إلا هذا العبد الحبشي وهذا البعير الناضح وجرّد
هذه القطيفة، فإذا مت فابعثي بهن إلى عمر، ففعلت.

— سيرة أعلام النبلاء، ج الراشدون ص ١٩ · <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1167>

English: "We have nothing of the Muslims' fay' except this Abyssinian servant, this water-carrying camel, and the worn nap of this blanket. When I die, send them to 'Umar. And she did."

عبرت: He kept an account of what was not his, and he closed it before he died.

61 • Sell my land and pay them back

He had been given a maintenance out of the treasury. The community voted it to him when he gave up trading, because a man cannot run a market stall and a state at once. It was lawful, it was agreed, and it was his.

On his deathbed he gave an instruction about it. Sell a piece of land of mine. Take the price. Pay it in against every dirham I have drawn.

فَلَمَّا حَضَرَتْهُ الْوَفَاةُ أَوْصَى أَنْ تَبَاعَ أَرْضٌ لَهُ وَيُصْرَفَ ثَمَنُهَا عِوَضَ مَا أَخَذَهُ مِنْ مَالِ الْمُسْلِمِينَ.

— ٢٦٦ ص ٢ في التاريخ ج ٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/957>

English: "When death came to him he directed that land of his be sold and its price paid over in compensation for what he had taken of the Muslims' property."

عبرت: He treated a lawful salary as a debt.

⚠ **Do not give a figure.** The sources give the salary as 6,000 dirhams a year (الكامل ج ٢), as half a sheep a day (سير الراشدون ص ١٤), and as 2,500 (سير الراشدون ص ١٤). The instruction is the point, not the amount, and a figure you cannot defend is worth nothing.

62 • The shroud

He gave instructions for his own washing — his wife أسماء بنت عميس^{رض}, and his son عبد الرحمن^{رض}. Then the shroud. Use the two garments I am wearing, and buy one more to go with them. And he said: the living need the new more than the dead.

وَقَالَ: الْحَيُّ أَحْوَجُ إِلَى الْجَدِيدِ مِنَ الْمَيِّتِ، إِنَّمَا هُوَ لِلْمُهْلَةِ وَالصَّدِيدِ.

— ٢٦٢ ص ٢ في التاريخ ج ٢ · <https://shamela.ws/book/21712/953>

English: "He said: the living have more need of the new than the dead — this is only for the decay."

عبرت: The last instruction he gave about himself was an instruction to spend less on himself.

63 • Monday night, and a grave already dug beside another

He died on the Monday evening. He had asked to be buried beside the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, so they dug there. عمر^{رضي} prayed over him in the Prophet's ﷺ mosque, four takbīrs. They carried him on the same bier the Prophet ﷺ had been carried on. Four men went down into the grave: his son عبد الرحمن^{رضي}, عمر^{رضي}, عثمان^{رضي}, and طلحة^{رضي}. They laid his head at the Prophet's ﷺ shoulders and put his niche against the Prophet's ﷺ niche. He was buried before morning came.

He was sixty-three — the age at which the Prophet ﷺ had died. Say that last, and then stop.

وقالت عائشة: مات ليلة الثلاثاء، ودفن قبل أن يصبح.

— سيرة أعلام النبلاء، ج الراشدون ص ١٩ — <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1167>

English: "Ā'isha said: he died on the night of Tuesday, and was buried before morning came."

عبرت: Two years and three months of authority, and it ended in a room, at night, with four men and a spade.

The graves diagram is fixed by one sentence on the same page — سيرة أعلام النبلاء، ج الراشدون ص ١٩ — <https://shamela.ws/book/10906/1167>:

رأس أبي بكر عند كتفي رسول الله صلى الله عليه وسلم، ورأس عمر عند حقوي أبي بكر.

⚠ **Do not say the burial was "in عائشة's house."** These pages say *beside the Prophet ﷺ*, and no more. The date the pages give is Monday evening, with eight nights remaining of جمادى الآخرة, 13 AH.

64 • "Had Sālim^{رضي} been alive"

The last card of the evening, and it is not about أبو بكر^{رضي}. Tell it after the grave, as the one step forward the timeline takes all night.

Eleven years after ^{رض}عمر, الإمامة was dying of the assassin's wound, and the question of who would follow him would not wait. He refused to name one man and set up a council of six instead.

And it is related that he said that had ^{رض}Sālim been alive, he would not have made it a council at all. Ibn 'Abd al-Barr ^{رحمه الله} explains what that means: he would have gone by ^{رض}Sālim's judgement about whom to appoint.

The room met ^{رض}Sālim tonight as a slave from ^{رض}إصطخر who led ^{رض}عمر in prayer at ^{رض}قُباء because he had the most Qur'an. Eleven years after he died holding a banner, the Commander of the Believers wished he were still in the room. Say that, and then go to the close.

وروي عن عمر أنه قال لما احتضر: لو كان سالمًا حيًّا لما جعلتها شُورى

— ^{البدايه والنهائيه ج ٧ ص ٥٠} · <https://shamela.ws/book/30097/3196>

English: "And it is related of 'Umar that he said, when death was upon him: Had Sālim been alive

I would not have made it a shūrā."

عبرت: Eleven years later, the man the Commander of the Faithful wished were still in the room was a freed slave who had died holding a banner.

⚠ **Say "it is related that..."** — that is Ibn Kathīr's ^{رحمه الله} own passive, and you keep it. A second, differently worded report at ^{سیر ج ١ ص ١٧٠} names **both Sālim^{رض} and Abū 'Ubayda^{رض}** ط, and **al-Dhahabī رحمه الله weakens its chain on the page. Do not merge the two.**

⚠ **And do not go one sentence past this into the شُورى itself.** ^{رض}عمر's death and the council are session 3's opening material, and tonight's job is done. If a slip reaches for it, say warmly that it is next week's evening — which is true, and which is also the question you leave them with.

Telling it: About eight minutes, and it is the whole reason the evening works. Slow to your slowest. Say once, before card 58, that the map has stopped moving — that single sentence tells the room the ending has begun, and they will settle. Five beats: the assessment of ^{رض}عمر, the public appointment, the three objects, the grave, and then one step forward in time.

The ★ cut here is cards 60, 61, 63 and 64. Cards 58 and 59 are the ones that go if the clock has beaten you — though 59 is cheap and the sentence *I have not appointed a relative over you* is worth thirty seconds of anybody's evening. Cards 61 and 62 are short enough to be footnotes to card 60 — a salary repaid, a shroud not bought — which keeps the momentum toward the grave.

Card 64 is the last thing said tonight before the close, and it is not about أبو بكر . That is the point of putting it there. The evening began with three men on the wrong side at أحد and ends eleven years past the grave with the Commander of the Believers wishing a freed slave from إصطخر were still in the room. Say it, do not explain it, and go to the Line.

What not to say: do not compare him to anyone, and do not draw a governance lesson out loud — the three objects do it silently and better. Do not add a eulogy. The plainest possible delivery of card 63 is the strongest one available to you, and anything you add takes weight out of it. And **do not go one sentence past card 64 into the شوری itself** — عمر's death and the council open session 3, and tonight's job is done.

If a slip asks — "why did he appoint a successor when the Prophet ﷺ did not?" Read what the page records him doing: he consulted, he wrote a document, he had it read aloud in public, he asked the people whether they were content, and he told them unprompted that he had not appointed a relative. That is the record. The wider question of the succession and the disputes around it is handled with اصول in session 3, and you do not settle it from the floor tonight. Use the deferral line in QA_BANK.md \$0, warmly, and offer to talk afterwards — you have fifteen minutes after the session and one-to-one is where this conversation belongs.

The close

1. **The Line**, with tonight's events lit up and nothing else — `line_s2_lit.png`.
2. **The Map**, at 13 AH, against where it stood when the room walked in — `map_s2_close_13ah.png`. *(Both of these open session 3 unchanged. That is the whole re-anchor mechanism: the room sees the continuity instead of being told about it.)*
3. **Tonight's عبرت lines**, all on one screen.
4. 🖐️ **[HANDS]** Hands up — what year are we in now?
5. Next week, as a question.
6. A loud السلام عليكم, then the dua. The room must know it has ended.

Telling the close: five minutes, and do not improvise any of it. The last hands-up is not decoration — it is the room proving to itself that it has kept the timeline, and it is the moment they walk out feeling competent. Give them a beat to answer. Then the عبرت screen, read once, without elaboration. Then the question for next week, and nothing after it. The salām is loud on purpose.

The five عبرت lines

These are **SLIDES.md** 's five, in **SLIDES.md** 's order — reconciled against the deck, which decides (**DECISIONS.md** #26). Slide 59 puts these same five on screen, **CUE.pdf** prints them, and the worksheet rules five blank lines for the room to write them in. Every one is a card's own عبرت line, copied unchanged; no new sentence has been written. Say each one, then move on.

1. **There is a kind of steadiness that is not stubbornness: it is refusing to treat an emergency as permission.** (*Act 1, card 3 — جيش أسامة*)
2. **The whole war was set moving from one camp, in one sitting, by a man who had just been told to go home.** (*Act 2, card 9 — the eleven banners at ذو القصة*)
3. **Preservation is not one heroic act; it is somebody doing a careful, unglamorous job properly.** (*Act 4, card 46 — زيد بن ثابت and the four materials*)
4. **What changed in Arabia was not how many men there were, but which way they were all facing.** (*Act 5, card 52 — Ibn Khaldūn رحمه الله, as he reads it*)
5. **He kept an account of what was not his, and he closed it before he died.** (*Act 7, card 60 — the servant, the camel, the blanket*)

⚠ **Do not substitute one of these on the night.** The five are said aloud, shown on the deck and written by the room on paper, so a drift of one word is visible to everyone in the hall.

If the deck is ever rebalanced, these are the strongest replacements — all likewise copied from their own cards, none of them a new sentence:

- *He did not tell them what to do; he told them what they had already been.* (card 24 — Thābit b. Qays at عقرباء)
- *The gate that decided the day was opened from the inside, by one man who had to argue his own side into throwing him.* (card 32 — al-Barā', and the house of Mālik)
- *Eleven years later, the man the Commander of the Faithful wished were still in the room was a freed slave who had died holding a banner.* (card 64 — Sālim)
- *They did not wait to find out how much had been lost before they secured what was left.* (card 42 — the number nobody can give)
- *A state that has just won a civil war and still refuses to conscript the defeated is telling you what it thinks it is for.* (card 53 — the order to Iraq)

One rule for all of them: they are drawn from the events and they stay there. No present-day parallel, from the lectern or in answer to a slip. The room contains an organisation with settled views, and the moment a عبرت line is heard as a comment on anything current, you have started adjudicating — which is the one thing this course does not do.